

2026 上

我是瑞斯拜六级

四六级我只看瑞斯拜

Life is like a marathon. There are ups and downs downs downs.



阅读

课程观看 B 站：我是瑞斯拜



请打印听课

作者：任一瑞

写在前面

各位亲爱的同学，六级考试词汇量要求是 5500 左右，但是即使你把所有的大纲词汇都记住了，你还是会遇到生词，这很正常。我在之前学习英语的时候，每每遇到生词就会记中文意思在旁边，积累的单词多了可以用英文来记新单词的含义。久而久之遇到的次数多了单词就记住了。我在课堂上会在讲到阅读的方法，但是这些方法都是基于单词的基础的。所以请大家一定要重视单词，勤动手记笔记。笔记不用单独准备笔记本，记在讲义上就行。

如果你词汇量低，可以先刷一刷词汇课 30 讲。再来听课会轻松得多。

阅读部分在英语四级考试中分为三个题型

SectionA 选词填空-这个题 10 个题只占 5%的分数，我们最后来冲刺 5 篇。

SectionB 长篇阅读-段落匹配 10 道题 10%的分数，学会方法较为简单，在课程上会讲系统的做题方法。由于页数较多不建议全部打印，讲义中仅展示一篇。大家需要刷题可以按照自己的需求打印。

SectionC 仔细阅读 10 道题 占 20%的分数，我们的课程是这个部分为主。

做题顺序：先做 sectionC，再做翻译，再做 sectionB，最后 SectionA

Text1

As interdependent beings we cannot thrive independent of others. We like to work with people who are like-minded, with whom we share a common interest, or who also believe in a cause we are serious about. This is evident in how we have organised ourselves into various collective groups such as nations, regions, communities, organisations, and families.

Does the group you belong to have a strong collective consciousness or shared beliefs? Is there interdependence among its members? Do you consider this group a significant part of your existence? If your answers are affirmative, then you are experiencing a micro version of solidarity.

What is solidarity? Its simplest definition in the dictionary is: "...a unifying opinion, feeling, purpose or interest among a group of people." In this increasingly diverse society we live in, solidarity takes on a complex and multifaceted character as it forms bonds of interdependence among unique individuals living a fast-changing environment and working within a complex division of labour.

One facet of solidarity fits well with the principles of communitarianism (社群主义). In this setting, individuals give up their own interests to serve the common good. However, its strict adherence to social cohesiveness and exclusiveness restricts expression and practice of individual differences and preferences. Consequently, individuality and autonomy is sacrificed to maintain the unity of the group.

Solidarity is also viewed as a reaction to the extreme emphasis on individualism and freedom of choice. It goes against the liberal idea of unrestricted individuals who see society as a hindrance to their freedom to make choices and to act according to what is good for them regardless of how these will affect others.

But despite its many facets, social theorists have viewed solidarity as a key factor in bringing about order and progress in society. They believe that for human society to survive as it becomes more diverse, more new bonds need to be formed based on the differences. In the light of this, they regard a genuine solidarity as more than just shallow relationships based on common interests. Solidarity is not just a product of strategic calculations of how much it will benefit the self. It is not an exclusive class founded on the you-and-me-against-the-world principle. Rather, it is inclusive and is not

forced. Acting out of solidarity means supporting and standing up for each other—in recognition that one's fate is in the fate of the other. It is a bond characterised by cooperative practices and strengthened by the concern for the well-being of others or the common good. It fights for the protection of human dignity and listens to and acts on the cries of the most vulnerable.

1. What does the author say about human beings?

- A. They cannot prosper without cooperating with each other.
- B. They share a common interest and believe in a just cause.
- C. They think and behave alike in different social groups.
- D. They cannot gain independence without fighting for it.

2. What do we learn about solidarity in an increasingly diverse society?

- A. It gives rise to a complicated division of labour.
- B. It involves many aspects with great complexity.
- C. It brings individuals together as environment changes.
- D. It embraces the characteristics of different individuals.

3. What would we witness in the setting of communitarianism?

- A. Ruling of social norms and ridding of individuality.
- B. Emphasis on the adherence to individual differences.
- C. Sacrifice of personal interests for the common good.
- D. Elimination of individualism and personal choices.

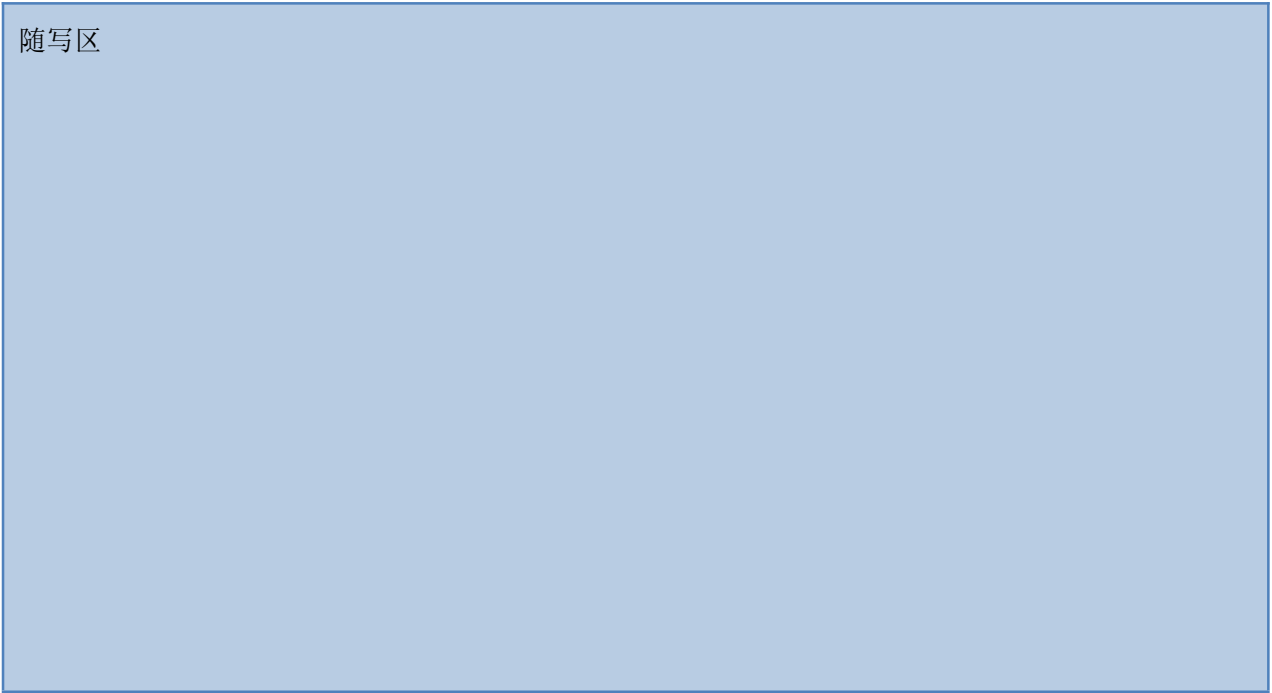
4. What does solidarity entail according to the passage?

- A. A limit to personal differences.
- B. An opposition to individualism.
- C. A hindrance to social advancement.
- D. An inevitable end to liberal pursuits.

5. What do social theorists think of solidarity?

- A. It is especially relevant to the most vulnerable.
- B. It is most effective in protecting human dignity.
- C. It is essential to progress and order in society.
- D. It is indispensable to avoiding shallow relationships.

随写区



Text2

原文：

People who repeatedly give unwanted advice can be well-meaning and genuinely want to help. Others might do this out of a sense of self-worth around the ability to influence others. One study found that people with a high tendency to seek power were more likely to give advice than those with an opposite tendency. Under the guise of unhelpfulness, people may be driven to give you unwanted advice because it makes them feel powerful or in control. They may not be fully aware of this drive, however.

These people may also display a problematic degree of emotional vulnerability, becoming upset very quickly, and taking a long time to calm down. It is possible that their emotions were only validated in childhood when they were at their loudest, encouraging them to adopt responses to discomfort that are excessive in most situations.

When someone is giving advice in order to make themselves feel more powerful, there is underlying anxiety to their behavior that recipients of the advice tend to notice. It can be tempting in this situation to react harshly to the advice giver and to accuse them of being manipulative, but this approach might produce an undesired result. If the act of giving advice is contributing actively to someone's feelings of self-worth, an outright (直率的) rejection may be perceived as a threat, activating their fight-or-flight response, possibly causing them to double down on their validation-seeking behavior, or leading to a larger conflict.

The key is to validate without over-identifying. You can let them know that you have heard them and appreciate where they are coming from without taking on the potentially damaging narrative that you could not have gotten by without their help. You had better say something like, "Thanks for the idea. I have my own plan for handling this, but I really appreciate your perspective and will take it into consideration. Can I let you know when I need help in the future?"

If you have trouble setting boundaries tactfully, prioritize working on your own ability to self-regulate. As uncomfortable as it may make you continuously receiving unwanted advice, if you can respond with compassion, the situation will likely diffuse much faster. Though it is usually not the intended outcome of giving unsolicited advice, many who receive it often feel stressed, offended, or simply annoyed by unwanted suggestions. Setting a boundary in this regard, if you feel you need one, is perfectly reasonable and

something that can bring you increased emotional safety. It is best to set boundaries in a way that takes into account the individual's underlying reasons for doing what they are doing to avoid unnecessary conflict and more stress.

题目：

7. What is the finding of one study about people who keep giving unsolicited advice?
 - A. They turn out to be well-meaning.
 - B. They are genuinely kind-hearted.
 - C. They are capable of influencing others.
 - D. They are inclined to crave for power.

8. What is the problem with people who are driven to give you unsolicited advice?
 - A. They may be quick to upset others.
 - B. They may be emotionally vulnerable.
 - C. They want their voice to be the loudest.
 - D. They respond to discomfort excessively.

9. What is the advice receiver tempted to do when noticing the advice giver's underlying anxiety?
 - A. Reveal the undesired result of their approach.
 - B. Refuse their advice in an undisguised manner.
 - C. Bring their real motives to the surface.
 - D. Accuse them of trying to control others.

10. How is the advice giver likely to react to the rejection of their advice?
 - A. They may regard it as a threat.
 - B. They may modify their behavior.
 - C. They get ready for a larger conflict.
 - D. They begin to doubt their self-worth.

11. What should the advice receiver do to avoid unnecessary conflict?
 - A. Concede the advice is perfectly reasonable.
 - B. Give their reasons for not taking the advice.
 - C. Understand why the advice giver offers the advice.
 - D. Explain their chosen way of handling the situation.

随写区

第三篇：正念与注意力经济 (Mindfulness and the Attention Economy)

原文：

Mindfulness has been shown to have a number of meaningful health benefits—it can help reduce anxiety and promote healing in those suffering from chronic illness. The practice is based on an insight first described in ancient Buddhist texts that human beings have the capacity to observe experience without being caught up in it. This means simply that it is possible to observe ourselves having a craving, or a happy thought, or even a scary emotion, without reacting in the moment in a way that amplifies the feeling or sends the mind spiraling off into thinking about old memories or anticipating events.

This practice of mindfulness can help calm the mind and the body as we learn not to react to experience with likes and dislikes or judgments of good and bad. It does not make us cold or indifferent but more fully present. One of the challenges of practicing mindfulness in our contemporary world is that there has been a profound transformation in human attention. The artist Jenny Odell argues that in our “attention economy” human attention has been transformed into a commodity that big corporations buy and sell. This economy rests on a technological revolution of mobile phones and social media that makes it possible for corporations to target our attention with their content at every moment.

The devices most people use are a perpetual diversion from the present moment. The result is that it can feel as though our ability to focus, and be fully present, has been stolen. But mindfulness can help us resist the attention economy and relish the things that make life special, like being together with those we love.

Most mindfulness research focuses on the individual benefits of the practice, but some scholars assert that we can not only practice mindfulness for ourselves but also practice it for others. It can help us build stronger, healthier relationships. The sad truth is that living in the attention economy, most of us have become bad listeners. However, just as it is possible to watch ourselves having an experience without reacting, it's possible to watch another person have an experience without getting tied up in reactivity and judgment.

The gift of mindfulness is a practice of listening with compassion to others

describe their experiences. To give this gift means putting away your phone, turning off social media, and setting aside other common distractions. It means practicing being fully present in another person's presence and listening to them with complete attention without judgment, while resisting the urge to make the interaction about you. If we judge the value of gifts based on their price, this gift may seem worthless, but in a distracted world, it is a precious one.

题目：

13. What do we learn from the passage about practicing mindfulness?
- A. It triggers our mind to reflect on past experiences or anticipate future events.
 - B. It focuses our attention on the present moment without making judgments.
 - C. It concentrates our mind on our personal feelings, happy or scary.
 - D. It helps our mind to stay calm when facing judgments from others.
14. What do we see in today's "attention economy" according to Jenny Odell?
- A. Focus on technological advances continuously updates products and services.
 - B. People's attention is turned into something that can be bought and sold.
 - C. Businesses profit from selling mobile phones and revolutionizing social media.
 - D. People tend to purchase products and services without careful thinking.
15. What happens with the prevalent use of mobile phones or social media?
- A. They keep distracting users from the here and now.
 - B. They render users incapable of resisting temptation.
 - C. They rob users of their ability to observe experience.
 - D. They tempt users to endorse the attention economy.
16. What benefit can practicing mindfulness bring to us according to some scholars?
- A. It prevents us from making arbitrary judgments about others.
 - B. It shifts our attention from material things to spiritual pursuits.
 - C. It is conducive to our forging better interpersonal relationships.
 - D. It is helpful in regaining our ability to enjoy what we have in life.
17. What do the author suggest we do in another person's presence?
- A. Share each other's experience frankly and compassionately.
 - B. Pay full attention to establishing close relationships with them.
 - C. Be attentive listeners while refraining from making judgments.

D. Remind them of the distraction from mobile phones and social media.

随写区



第四篇：验证码与数字劳动 (Captchas and Digital Labor)

原文：

The other day I had to log into a service I hadn't used before. Since I was a new user, the website decided that it needed to check I wasn't a robot and so set me a Captcha test to determine whether the user is a person or a machine. I was presented with an image of a roadside scene over which was laid a grid. My “challenge” was to click on each cell in the grid that contained a traffic sign. I did so, a bit irritated. Then I was presented with another image and another grid—also with a request to identify road signs. Like a lamb, I complied, after which the website accepted my input.

And then I realised what I had been doing was adding to a dataset for training the machine-learning software that guides self-driving cars. So, to gain access to an automated service that will benefit financially from my input, I first have to do some unpaid labour to help improve the performance of autonomous vehicles.

Neat, eh? But note also the delicious additional irony that the Captcha is described as an “automated Turing test”. The Turing test was conceived, you may recall, as a way of enabling humans to determine whether a machine could respond in such a way that one couldn't tell whether it was a human or a robot. So we have wandered into a world in which machines make us do tricks to prove that we are humans!

The strangest aspect of this unparalleled shift is how under-discussed it has been. The metaphor of the boiling frog comes to mind. Have we become so subtly conditioned by digital technology that we don't see what's been happening to us? Have we been conditioned to accept a world governed by “smart” tech, trading convenience to the point where we become a bit like machines ourselves?

In a recent startling and thoughtful book, two scholars—Brett Frischmann, a law professor, and Evan Selinger, a philosopher—argue that the answer to that question is “yes”. And they're right. There's nothing technophobic (技术恐惧的) about that. We shape our tools and then our tools shape us. Technology is supposed to provide tools that serve human ends. But, as the machine-learning Captcha demonstrates, a significant proportion of digital tech now sees (and uses) humans as means to ends that are not ours. In the process, they reduce us to the status of cheery rats running on treadmills (踏板车) designed by people who do not have our interests at heart. So back to the frog

metaphor. Are we smart enough to jump out before it's too late? You don't even have to Google it to know the answer.

题目：

19. How did the author respond to the Captcha test?

- A. He clicked on the cells randomly.
- B. He accepted the challenge readily.
- C. He completed it confidently.
- D. He worked on it submissively.

20. What is ironic about the Captcha test?

- A. A machine can respond to the test as well as humans do.
- B. A machine can outperform humans in object identification.
- C. A test designed to test machines is now used by machines to test humans.
- D. A test conceived to tell a human from a robot can now do tricks humans can't.

21. Why does the author use the metaphor of the boiling frog?

- A. To show that humans are unwilling to trade convenience for control by smart tech.
- B. To show that humans are unaware of the potential danger brought by smart tech.
- C. To question whether humans are conditioned to accept digital tech.
- D. To question whether humans are as vulnerable as the boiling frog.

22. Why does the author think that Brett Frischmann and Evan Selinger are right?

- A. A large part of digital tech is now making use of humans to meet its own ends.
- B. Humans are now fast locked in a race against digital tech to control the world.
- C. Digital tech can serve human needs in ways previously thought impossible.
- D. Digital tech is now doing thinking while humans are doing repetitive work.

23. What does the author imply by asking “Are we smart enough to jump out before it's too late?” at the end of the passage?

- A. It is not sensible to expect digital tech to take humans' interest to heart.

- B. It is hard to say whether technology or humans will get the upper hand.
- C. We may have to search the web to get the answer to the question.
- D. We may not awake in time to the danger digital tech poses to us.

随写区



第五篇：成功路上的个人主义与友谊 (Individualism vs. Friendship)

原文：

Many see friendships as a comfort blanket: a shoulder to cry on, a reliable soul to confide in. However, more often than not, in our eagerness to seek individual success, we lose friends along the way and that has become part of the process. The chaos and never-ending turmoil that accompanies everyday life is an appropriate obstacle in the pursuit of stable friendships. As students, we use this excuse to shrug off losing people who we once thought to be loved ones.

Instead of viewing our lives as a race, where everyone is on their own path to some form of success, we must relearn to value the connections we make along the track. We must reevaluate the harm of radical individual freedom. Radical individualism elevates the freedom of the individual over the collective. It argues, for instance, that universal healthcare, an example of collectivism, dims the dreams of many Americans.

Many of us have fallen victim to an individualistic culture. Society tends to celebrate personal achievement and commend it based on the assumption that winning or succeeding is a consequence of working harder than the next person. As a society, we idolize the concept of “losing friends on the road to success.” I remember hearing in high school, “Don't worry about losing friendships, just focus on study and getting into college. That's all that will matter in the long run,” a sentiment that is not unique to my experience. It's preached in many success stories, and it's embedded in the way we see growth. Motivational speakers will push their audience to be complacent to the inevitable end of losing friends. Spend too much time with friends? You're losing time better utilized on your achievements. Invest time in your relationships? Invest time in your work instead.

This constant need to succeed has blinded us from seeing through the whirlwind of change that accompanies our everyday lives. We are expected to tangibly succeed, earn awards, get higher positions, earn better grades. In order to succeed, we lose friends, and that has sadly become normalized. We cannot be complacent with losing friendships because they are our anchors.

Yes, pursue success. Challenge yourself. Push limits. But contrary to all the self-proclaimed success experts, doing it alone does not make you more

successful or any better than someone who achieved it with the help of others. Put effort into fostering healthy relationships, and maintaining them through your busy schedule that seems like it leaves no time for anyone else. Although we may be living in a society that treasures the independent pursuit of achievement, having people to support and love you on the way is far more important than any end result.

题目：

25. What often happens when people are eager to pursue individual success?

- A. They lack a shoulder to cry on.
- B. They have no soul to confide in.
- C. They cannot find reliable friends.
- D. They ignore their ties with friends.

26. What does the author advise people to do in their pursuit of radical individualism?

- A. Reexamine its detrimental effects.
- B. Shrug off the loss of their loved ones.
- C. Avoid the chaos and turmoil involved.
- D. Remove aggressive obstacles in the way.

27. What is American society's assumption of personal achievement?

- A. It is to be duly celebrated and highly commended.
- B. It is a sure way to fulfill a person's dream.
- C. It revolves around an individualistic culture.
- D. It reflects a person's exceptional endeavor.

28. What is preached in many success stories?

- A. Attaching importance to academic gains on the road to success.
- B. Investing one's time in work instead of connecting with friends.
- C. Trying to strengthen friendships in one's pursuit of personal success.
- D. Excelling in academic performance to get into a prestigious college.

29. What can we infer from the passage regarding the pursuit of success?

- A. No one can succeed without pushing limits.
- B. No one can afford to neglect close friends.
- C. Collectivism is superior to individualism.
- D. Success experts often lead people to ruin.

第六篇：公平、历史与马丁·路德·金 (Equity and MLK's Legacy)

原文：

During his acceptance speech for the Nobel Peace Prize, Martin Luther King Jr. said, "I believe that unarmed truth and unconditional love will have the final word in reality." More than five decades later, our society is still struggling to separate truth from fantasy, fact from fiction. From disputes over the climate change to debates about how slavery is taught, America is at a crossroads. And the battle for equity is at the heart of these vital conversations.

Study after study shows that inequality has appalling consequences. A 2020 report by Citi indicated that "Black students could have increased their lifetime incomes 90—113 billion" if equity issues related to higher education had been adequately addressed over the past two decades. This statistic represents a flood of issues we've failed to confront as a nation. It also highlights one truth: We're missing out on valuable opportunities to bridge the differences that divide us. However, by honoring King's legacy, we can get our country back on the path toward true equality.

Students—and adults for that matter—simply cannot understand the conflicts we have today without understanding what caused them in the first place. That means we have a responsibility to help them make connections between U.S. history and current events. It also means giving them the tools they need to address inequity and bias in their own lives. Adherence to these principles, along with a commitment to truthful dialogue, can help every student better appreciate how far we've come and more clearly see the roads we have yet to travel.

With more truthful analysis of the need for more qualified, diverse educators, we can improve our recruiting, training, and retention strategies for schools across the country. Unfortunately, our deeply rooted divisions are delaying these advancements. A recent survey found that 77 percent of Americans believe the nation is "more divided than ever before." But reports of increased polarization shouldn't persuade us to look away from one another. Instead, they should compel us to address our shared issues head-on.

We are not, as some would suggest, living in a "post-racial society." We simply cannot afford to keep our heads buried in the sand when it comes to racial inequity. Unless we get honest about intolerance, bias, and how these social diseases impair the ways we treat one another, injustice will continue to haunt

us. But our children and our grandchildren deserve better. On this Martin Luther King Day and beyond, let's commit to working together to disrupt the status quo. Let's continue to build a better, more inclusive nation; and in the words of Martin Luther King Jr., "A society at peace with itself, a society that can live with its conscience."

题目：

31. What does the author think about today's America?

- A. It is struggling to transform fiction into reality.
- B. It has been the focus of many vital conversations.
- C. It still has a long way to go before equity can be truly realized.
- D. It has got to a point where people disagree on nearly every issue.

32. What do we learn from the passage about black students in the past 20 years?

- A. They have been unfairly treated regarding higher education.
- B. They have been battling hard to address equity issues.
- C. They have boosted their lifetime incomes by billions of dollars.
- D. They have come to see the consequences of racial discrimination.

33. How can Americans bridge the differences that divide them?

- A. By dealing with the thorny issues confronting them.
- B. By seizing every chance to enhance racial harmony.
- C. By continuing to pursue Martin Luther King Jr.'s cause.
- D. By striving to identify exceedingly valuable opportunities.

34. How do most Americans view America as a nation according to a recent survey?

- A. It is compelled to address its historical social issues.
- B. It is delaying advancements toward racial equality.
- C. It has kept itself from polarization.
- D. It has become increasingly split.

35. What does the author suggest Americans do?

- A. Ensure the wellbeing of their children and grandchildren.
- B. Make joint efforts to tackle the nation's equity issues.
- C. Restrain their intolerance and discrimination.
- D. Restore social order for a harmonious nation.

答案：

36. C | 52. A | 53. C | 54. D | 55. B

词汇拓展：请将文中生词整理誊写至下面区域

生词	文中搭配	中文释义

随写区

TEXT7

Human memory is notoriously unreliable. Even people with the sharpest facial-recognition skills can only remember so much.

It's tough to quantify how good a person is at remembering. No one really knows how many different faces someone can recall, for example, but various estimates tend to hover in the thousands-based on the number of acquaintances a person might have.

Machines aren't limited this way. Give the right computer a massive database of faces, and it can process what it sees-then recognize a face it's told to find-with remarkable speed and precision. This skill is what supports the enormous promise of facial-recognition software in the 21st century. It's also what makes contemporary surveillance systems so scary.

The thing is, machines still have limitations when it comes to facial recognition. And scientists are only just beginning to understand what those constraints are. To begin to figure out how

computers are struggling, researchers at the University of Washington created a massive database of faces- they call it MegaFace- and tested a variety of facial-recognition algorithms (算法) as they

scaled up in complexity. The idea was to test the machines on a database that included up to 1 million different images of nearly 700,000 different people-and not just a large database featuring a relatively small number of different faces, more consistent with what's been used in other research.

As the databases grew, machine accuracy dipped across the board. Algorithms that were right 95% of the time when they were dealing with a 13, 000-image database, for example, were accurate about 70% of the time when confronted with 1 million images. That's still pretty good, says one of the researchers, Ira Kemelmacher-Shlizerman. "Much better than we expected," she said.

Machines also had difficulty adjusting for people who look a lot alike-either doppelgangers(长相极相似的人), whom the machine would have trouble identifying as two separate people, or the same person who appeared in different photos at different ages or in different lighting, whom the

machine would incorrectly view as separate people.

"Once we scale up, algorithms must be sensitive to tiny changes in identities and at the same time invariant to lighting, pose, age," Kemelmacher-Shlizerman said.

The trouble is, for many of the researchers who'd like to design systems to address these challenges, massive datasets for experimentation just don't exist--at least, not in formats that are accessible to academic researchers. Training sets like the ones Google and Facebook have are private. There are no public databases that contain millions of faces. MegaFace's creators say it's the largest publicly available facial-recognition dataset out there.

"An ultimate face recognition algorithm should perform with billions of people in a dataset," the researchers wrote.

46. Compared with human memory, machines can .

- A) identify human faces more efficiently
- B) tell a friend from a mere acquaintance
- C) store an unlimited number of human faces
- D) perceive images invisible to the human eye

47. Why did researchers create MegaFace?

- A) To enlarge the volume of the facial-recognition database
- B) To increase the variety of facial-recognition software
- C) To understand computers' problems with facial recognition
- D) To reduce the complexity of facial-recognition algorithms

48. What does the passage say about machine accuracy?

- A) It falls short of researchers' expectations.
- B) It improves with added computing power.
- C) It varies greatly with different algorithms.
- D) It decreases as the database size increases.

49. What is said to be a shortcoming of facial-recognition machines?

- A) They cannot easily tell apart people with near-identical appearances.
- B) They have difficulty identifying changes in facial expressions
- C) They are not sensitive to minute changes in people's mood
- D) They have problems distinguishing people of the same age

50. What is the difficulty confronting researchers of facial-recognition machines?

- A) No computer is yet able to handle huge datasets of human faces
- B) There do not exist public databases with sufficient face sampler
- C) There are no appropriate algorithms to process the face samples
- D) They have trouble converting face datasets into the right format.

阅读答案：ACDAB

词汇拓展：

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词汇拓展		
生词	文中搭配	中文释义
随写区		

TEXT8

There' re currently 21.5 million students in America, and many will be funding their college on borrowed money. Given that there's now over \$1.3 trillion in student loans on the books, it's pretty clear that many students are far from sensible. The average student's debt upon graduation now approaches \$40, 000, and as college becomes ever more expensive, calls to make it "free" are multiplying. Even Hillary Clinton says that when it comes to college, "Costs won't be a barrier. "

But the only way college could be free is if the faculty and staff donated their time, the buildings required no maintenance, and campuses required no utilities. As long as it's impossible to produce something from nothing costs are absolutely a barrier.

The actual question we debate is who should pay for people to go to college. If taxpayers are to bear the cost of forgiving student loans, shouldn't they have a say in how their money is used?

At least taxpayers should be able to decide what students will study on the public dime. If we're going to force taxpayers to foot the bill for college degrees, students should only study those subjects that ' re of greatest benefit to taxpayers. After all, students making their own choices in this respect is what caused the problem in the first place. We simply don't need more poetry, gender studies, or sociology majors. How do we know which subjects benefit society? Easy.

Average starting salaries give a clear indication of what type of training society needs its new workers to have. Certainly, there're benefits to a college major beyond the job a student can perform. But if we're talking about the benefits to society, the only thing that matters is what the major enables the student to produce for society. And the value of what the student can produce is reflected in the wage employers are willing to pay the student to produce it.

A low wage for elementary school teachers, however, doesn't mean elementary education isn' t important. It simply means there're too many elementary school teachers already.

Meanwhile, there're few who're willing and able to perform jobs requiring a petroleum engineering major, so the value of one more of those people is very high

So we can have taxpayers pick up students' tuition in exchange for dictating what those students will study. Or we can allow students both to choose their majors and pay for their education themselves. But in the end ,one of two things is true:

Either a college major is worth its cost or it isn't. If yes, taxpayer financing isn't needed If not taxpayer financing isn't desirable. Either way, taxpayers have no business paying for students' college education.

51.What does the author think of college students funding their education through loans?

- A)They only expect to get huge returns.
- C)They benefit at taxpayers expense.
- B)They are acting in an irrational way.
- D)They will regret doing so someday.

52.In the author's opinion, free college education is .

- A) impractical
- B)unsustainable
- C)a goal to strive for
- D) a way to social equality

53.What should students do if taxpayers are to bear their college costs?

- A)Work even harder to repay society.
- B)Choose their subjects more carefully.
- C)Choose majors that will serve society's practical need.
- D)Allow taxpayers to participate in college administration.

54.What does the author say about the value of a student's college education?

- A)It is underestimated by profit-seeking employers.
- B) It is to be proved by what they can do on the job.
- C) It is well reflected in their average starting salary.
- D) It is embodied in how they remove social barriers.

55.What message does the author want to convey in the passage?

- A)Students should think care fully whether to go to college
- B) Taxpayers should only finance the most gifted students.
- C)The worth of a college education is open to debate.
- D) College students should fund their own education..

阅读答案：BACAD

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TEXT9

Economically speaking, are we better off than we were ten years ago? Twenty years ago? In their thirst for evidence on this issue, commentators seized on the recent report by the

Census Bureau, which found that average household income rose by 5.2% in 2015. Unfortunately, that conclusion puts too much weight on a useful, but flawed and incomplete, statistic. Among the more significant problems with the Census' s measure are that: 1) it excludes taxes, transfers, and compensation like employer-provided health insurance; and 2) it is based on surveys rather than data. Even if precisely measured, income data exclude important determinants of economic well-being, such as the hours of work needed to earn that income.

While thinking about the question, we came across a recently published article by Charles Jones and Peter Klenow, which proposes an interesting new measure of economic welfare. While by no means perfect, it is considerably more comprehensive than average income, taking into account not only growth in consumption per person but also changes in working time, life expectancy, and inequality. Moreover, it can be used to assess economic performance both across countries and over time.

The Jones-Klenow method can be illustrated by a cross-country example. Suppose we want to compare the economic welfare of citizens of the U.S. and France in 2005.

In 2005, as the authors observe, real consumption per person in France was only 60% as high as the U.S., making it appear that Americans were economically much better off than the French on average. However, that comparison omits other relevant factors: leisure time, life expectancy, and economic inequality. The French take longer vacations and retire earlier, so typically work fewer hours; they enjoy a higher life expectancy, presumably reflecting advantages with respect to health care, diet, lifestyle, and the like; and income and consumption are somewhat more equally distributed there than in the U.S. Because of these differences, comparing France' s consumption with the U.S.' s overstates the gap in economic welfare.

Similar calculations can be used to compare the U.S. and other countries. For example, this calculation puts economic welfare in the United Kingdom at 97% of U.S. levels, but estimates Mexican well-being at 22%.

The Jones-Klenow measure can also assess an economy' s performance over time. According to this measure, as of the early-to-mid-2000s, the U.S. had the highest economic welfare of any large country. Since 2007, economic welfare in the U.S. has continued to improve. However,

the pace of improvement has slowed markedly.

Methodologically, the lesson from the Jones-Klenow research is that economic welfare is multi-dimensional. Their approach is flexible enough that in principle other important quality-of-

life changes could be incorporated—for example, decreases in total emissions of pollutants and

declines in crime rates.

46.What does the author think of the 2015 report by the Census Bureau?

- A) It is based on questionable statistics.
- B) It reflects the economic changes.
- C) It evidences the improved welfare.
- D) It provides much food for thought.

47.What does the author say about the Jones-Klenow method?

- A) It is widely used to compare the economic growth across countries.
- B) It revolutionizes the way of measuring ordinary people's livelihood.
- C) It focuses on people's consumption rather than their average income.
- D) It is a more comprehensive measure of people's economic well-being.

48.What do Jones and Klenow think of the comparison between France and the U.S. in terms of real consumption per person?

- A) It reflected the existing big gap between the two economies.
- B) It neglected many important indicators of people's welfare.
- C) It covered up the differences between individual citizens.
- D) It failed to count in their difference in natural resources.

49.What is an advantage of the Jones-Klenow method?

- A) It can accurately pinpoint a country's current economic problems.
- B) It can help to raise people's awareness of their economic well-being.
- C) It can diagnose the causes of a country's slowing pace of economic improvement.
- D) It can compare a country's economic conditions between different periods of time.

50.What can we infer from the passage about American people's economic well-being? A) It is much better than that of their European counterparts.

- B) It has been on the decline ever since the turn of the century.
- C) It has not improved as much as reported by the Census Bureau.
- D) It has not been accurately assessed and reported since mid-2000s.

阅读答案：ADBDC

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TEXT10

If you've ever started a sentence with, "If I were you..." or found yourself scratching your head at a colleague's agony over a decision when the answer is crystal-clear, there's a scientific reason behind it. Our own decision-making abilities can become depleted over the course of the day causing indecision or poor choices, but choosing on behalf of someone else is an enjoyable task that doesn't suffer the same pitfalls.

The problem is "decision fatigue," a psychological phenomenon that takes a toll on the quality of your choices after a long day of decision making, says Evan Polman, a leading psychologist.

Physicians who have been on the job for several hours, for example, are more likely to prescribe antibiotics to patients when it's unwise to do so. "Presumably it's because it's simple and easy to write a prescription and consider a patient case closed rather than investigate further," Polman says.

But decision fatigue goes away when you are making the decision for someone else. When people imagine themselves as advisers and imagine their own choices as belonging to someone else, they feel less tired and rely less on decision shortcuts to make those choices. "By taking upon the role of adviser rather than decision maker, one does not suffer the consequences of decision fatigue," he says. "It is as if there is something fun and liberating about making someone else's choice."

Getting input from others not only offers a fresh perspective and thought process, it often also includes riskier choices. While this sounds undesirable, it can be quite good, says Polman. "When people experience decision fatigue—when they are tired of making choices—they have a tendency to choose to go with status quo (现状)," he says. "But the status quo can be problematic, since a change in the course of action can sometimes be important and lead to a positive outcome."

In order to achieve a successful outcome or reward, some level of risk is almost always essential. "People who are susceptible to decision fatigue will likely choose to do nothing over something," he says. "That's not to say that risk is always good, but it is related to taking action, whereas decision fatigue assuredly leads to inaction and the possible chagrin (懊恼) of a decision maker who might otherwise prefer a new course but is unfortunately hindered."

Just because you can make good choices for others doesn't mean you'll do the same for yourself, Polman cautions. "Research has found that women negotiate higher salaries for others than they do for themselves," he says, adding that people slip in and out of decision roles.

51.What does the author say about people making decisions?

- A)They may become exhausted by making too many decisions for themselves.
- B)They are more cautious in making decisions for others than for themselves.
- C)They tend to make decisions the way they think advantageous to them.
- D)They show considerable differences in their decision-making abilities.

52.What does the example about the physicians illustrate?

- A)Patients seldom receive due care towards the end of the day.
- B)Prescription of antibiotics can be harmful to patients'health.
- C)Decision fatigue may prevent people making wise decisions.
- D)Medical doctors are especially susceptible to decision fatigue.

53.When do people feel less decision fatigue?

- A)When they take decision shortcuts.
- B)When they help others to make decisions.
- C)When they have major decisions to make.
- D)When they have advisers to turn to.

54.What are people likely to do when decision fatigue sets in?

- A)They turn to physicians for advice.
- B)They tend to make risky decisions.
- C)They adopt a totally new perspective.
- D)They refrain from trying anything new.

55.What does the passage say about taking some risk in decision making?

- A)It is vital for one to reach the goal desired.
- B)It is likely to entail serious consequences.
- C)It will enable people to be more creative.
- D)It will more often than not end in regret.

阅读答案：ACBDA

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TEXT11

Perhaps it is time for farmers to put their feet up now that robots are used to inspect crops, dig up weeds, and even have become shepherds, too. Commercial growing fields are astronomically huge and take thousands of man-hours to operate. One prime example is one of Australia's most isolated cattle stations, Suplejack Downs in the Northern Territory, extending across 4,000 square kilometers, taking over 13 hours to reach by car from the nearest major town—Alice Springs.

The extreme isolation of these massive farms leaves them often unattended, and monitored only once or twice a year, which means if the livestock falls ill or requires assistance, it can be a long time for farmers to discover.

However, robots are coming to the rescue.

Robots are currently under a two-year trial in Wales which will train “farmbots” to herd, monitor the health of livestock, and make sure there is enough pasture for them to graze on. The robots are equipped with many sensors to identify conditions of the environment, cattle and food, using thermal and vision sensors that detect changes in body temperature.

“You’ve also got color, texture and shape sensors looking down at the ground to check pasture quality,” says Salah Sukkarieh of the University of Sydney, who will carry out trials on several farms in central New South Wales.

During the trials, the robot algorithms (算法) and mechanics will be fine-tuned to make it better suited to ailing livestock and ensure it safely navigates around potential hazards including trees, mud, swamps, and hills.

“We want to improve the quality of animal health and make it easier for farmers to maintain large landscapes where animals roam free,” says Sukkarieh.

The robots are not limited to herding and monitoring livestock. They have been created to count individual fruit, inspect crops, and even pull weeds.

Many robots are equipped with high-tech sensors and complex learning algorithms to avoid injuring humans as they work side by side. The robots also learn the most efficient and safest passages, and allow engineers and farmers to analyze and better optimize the attributes and tasks of the robot, as well as provide a live stream giving real-time feedback on exactly what is happening on the farms.

Of course, some worry lies in replacing agricultural workers. However, it is farmers that are pushing for the advancements due to ever-increasing labor vacancies, making it difficult to maintain large-scale operations.

The robots have provided major benefits to farmers in various ways, from hunting and pulling weeds to monitoring the condition of every single fruit. Future farms will likely experience a greater deal of autonomy as robots take up more and more farm work efficiently.

46. What may farmers be able to do with robots appearing on the farming scene?

- A) Upgrade farm produce
- B) Enjoy more leisure hours.
- C) Modify the genes of crops.
- D) Cut down farming costs.

47. What will “farmbots” be expected to do?

- A) Take up many of the farmers’ routines.
- B) Provide medical treatments for livestock.
- C) Lead the trend in farming the world over.
- D) Improve the quality of pastures for grazing.

48. What can robots do when equipped with high-tech sensors and complex learning algorithms?

- A) Help farmers choose the most efficient and safest passages.
- B) Help farmers simplify their farming tasks and management.
- C) Allow farmers to learn instantly what is occurring on the farm.
- D) Allow farmers to give them real-time instructions on what to do.

49. Why are farmers pressing for robotic farming?

- A) Farming costs are fast increasing.
- B) Robotics technology is maturing.
- C) Robotic farming is the trend.
- D) Labor short is worsening

50. What does the author think future farms will be like?

- A) More and more automated.
- B) More and more productive.
- C) Larger and larger in scale.
- D) Better and better in condition.

阅读答案：BACDA

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TEXT12

The public must be able to understand the basics of science to make informed decisions. Perhaps the most dramatic example of the negative consequences of poor communication between scientists and the public is the issue of climate change, where a variety of factors, not the least of which is a breakdown in the transmission of fundamental climate data to the general public, has contributed to widespread mistrust and misunderstanding of scientists and their research.

The issue of climate change also illustrates how the public acceptance and understanding of science (or the lack of it) can influence governmental decision-making with regard to regulation, science policy and research funding.

However, the importance of effective communication with a general audience is not limited to hot issues like climate change. It is also critical for socially charged neuroscience issues such as the genetic basis for a particular behavior, the therapeutic potential of stem cell therapy for neurodegenerative diseases, or the use of animal models, areas where the public understanding of science can also influence policy and funding decisions. Furthermore, with continuing advances in individual genome (基因组) sequencing and the advent of personalized medicine, more non-scientists will need to be comfortable analyzing complex scientific information to make decisions that directly affect their quality of life.

Science journalism is the main channel for the popularization of scientific information among the public. Much has been written about how the relationship between scientists and the media can shape the efficient transmission of scientific advances to the public. Good science journalists are specialists in making complex topics accessible to a general audience, while adhering to scientific accuracy.

Unfortunately, pieces of science journalism can also oversimplify and generalize their subject material to the point that the basic information conveyed is obscured or at worst, obviously wrong. The impact of a basic discovery on human health can be exaggerated so that the public thinks a miraculous cure is a few months to years away when in reality the significance of the study is far more limited.

Even though scientists play a part in transmitting information to journalists and ultimately the public, too often the blame for ineffective communication is placed on the side of the journalists. We believe that at least part of the problem lies in places other than the interaction between scientists and members of the media, and exists because for one thing we underestimate how difficult it is for scientists to communicate effectively with a diversity of audiences, and for another most scientists do not receive formal training in science communication.

51. What does the example of climate change serve to show?

- A)The importance of climate data is increasingly recognized.
- B)Adequate government funding is vital to scientific research.
- C)Government regulation helps the public understand science.
- D)Common folks' scientific knowledge can sway policy making.

52. What should non-scientists do to ensure their quality of life?

- A)Seek personalized medical assistance from doctors.
- B)Acquire a basic understanding of medical science.
- C)Have their individual genome sequenced.
- D)Make informed use of animal models.

53.Why is it important for scientists to build a good relationship with the media?

- A)It helps them to effectively popularize new scientific information.
- B)It enables the public to develop a positive attitude toward science.
- C)It helps them to establish a more positive public image.
- D)It enables them to apply their findings to public health.

54.What does the author say is the problem with science journalism?

- A)It is keen on transmitting sensational information.
- B)It tends to oversimplify people's health problems.
- C)It may give inaccurate or distorted information to the public.
- D)It may provide information open to different interpretations.

55.What should scientists do to impart their latest findings to the public more effectively?

- A)Give training to science journalists.
- B)Stimulate public interest in science.
- C)Seek timely assistance from the media.
- D)Improve their communication skills.

阅读答案：DBACD

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TEXT13

While human achievements in mathematics continue to reach new levels of complexity, many of us who aren't mathematicians at heart (or engineers by trade) may struggle to remember the last time we used calculus (微积分).

It's a fact not lost on American educators, who amid rising math failure rates are debating how math can better meet the real-life needs of students. Should we change the way math is taught in schools, or eliminate some courses entirely?

Andrew Hacker, Queens College political science professor, thinks that advanced algebra and other higher-level math should be cut from curricula in favor of courses with more routine usefulness, like statistics.

"We hear on all sides that we're not teaching enough mathematics, and the Chinese are running rings around us," Hacker says. "I'm suggesting we're teaching too much mathematics to too many people...not everybody has to know calculus. If you're going to become an aeronautical (航空的) engineer, fine. But most of us aren't."

Instead, Hacker is pushing for more courses like the one he teaches at Queens College: Numeracy 101. There, his students of "citizen statistics" learn to analyze public information like the federal budget and corporate reports. Such courses, Hacker argues, are a remedy for the numerical illiteracy of adults who have completed high-level math like algebra but are unable to calculate the price of, say, a carpet by area.

Hacker's argument has met with opposition from other math educators who say what's needed is to help students develop a better relationship with math earlier, rather than teaching them less math altogether.

Maria Droujkova is a founder of Natural Math, and has taught basic calculus concepts to 5-year-olds. For Droujkova, high-level math is important, and what it could use in American classrooms is an injection of childlike wonder.

"Make mathematics more available," Droujkova says. "Redesign it so it's more accessible to more kinds of people: young children, adults who worry about it, adults who may have had bad experiences."

Pamela Harris, a lecturer at the University of Texas at Austin, has a similar perspective. Harris says that American education is suffering from an epidemic of "fake math"—an emphasis on rote memorization (死记硬背) of formulas and steps, rather than an understanding of how math can influence the ways we see the world.

Andrew Hacker, for the record, remains skeptical.

"I'm going to leave it to those who are in mathematics to work out the ways to make their subject interesting and exciting so students want to take it," Hacker says. "All that I ask is that alternatives be offered instead of putting all of us on the road to calculus."

46. What does the author say about ordinary Americans?

- A) They struggle to solve math problems.
- B) They think math is a complex subject.
- C) They find high-level math of little use.
- D) They work hard to learn high-level math.

47. What is the general complaint about America's math education according to Hacker?

- A) America is not doing as well as China.
- B) Math professors are not doing a good job.
- C) It doesn't help students develop their literacy.
- D) There has hardly been any innovation for years.

48. What does Andrew Hacker's Numeracy 101 aim to do?

- A) Allow students to learn high-level math step by step.
- B) Enable students to make practical use of basic math.
- C) Lay a solid foundation for advanced math studies.
- D) Help students to develop their analytical abilities.

49. What does Maria Droujkova suggest math teachers do in class?

- A) Make complex concepts easy to understand.
- B) Start teaching children math at an early age.
- C) Help children work wonders with calculus.
- D) Try to arouse students' curiosity in math.

50. What does Pamela Harris think should be the goal of math education?

- A) To enable learners to understand the world better.
- B) To help learners to tell fake math from real math.
- C) To broaden Americans' perspectives on math.
- D) To exert influence on world development.

阅读答案：CABAC

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TEXT14

For years, the U.S. has experienced a shortage of registered nurses. The Bureau of Labor Statistics projects that while the number of nurses will increase by 19 percent by 2022, demand will grow faster than supply, and that there will be over one million unfilled nursing jobs by then.

So what's the solution? Robots.

Japan is ahead of the curve when it comes to this trend. Toyohashi University of Technology has developed Terapio, a robotic medical cart that can make hospital rounds, deliver medications and other items, and retrieve records. It follows a specific individual, such as a doctor or nurse, who can use it to record and access patient data. This type of robot will likely be one of the first to be implemented in hospitals because it has fairly minimal patient contact.

Robots capable of social engagement help with loneliness as well as cognitive functioning, but the robot itself doesn't have to engage directly—it can serve as an intermediary for human communication. Telepresence robots such as MantaroBot, Vgo, and Giraff can be controlled through a computer, smartphone, or tablet, allowing family members or doctors to remotely monitor patients or Skype them, often via a screen where the robot's 'face' would be. If you can't get to the nursing home to visit grandma, you can use a telepresence robot to hang out with her. A 2016 study found that users had a “consistently positive attitude” about the Giraff robot's ability to enhance communication and decrease feelings of loneliness.

A robot's appearance affects its ability to successfully interact with humans, which is why the RIKEN-TRI Collaboration Center for Human-Interactive Robot Research decided to develop a robotic nurse that looks like a huge teddy bear. RIBA (Robot for Interactive Body

On the less cute and more scary side there is Actroid F, which is so human-like that some patients may not know the difference. This conversational robot companion has cameras in its eyes, which allow it to track patients and use appropriate facial expressions and body language in its interactions. During a month-long hospital trial, researchers asked 70 patients how they felt being around the robot and “only three or four said they didn't like having it around.”

It's important to note that robotic nurses don't decide courses of treatment or make diagnoses (though robot doctors and surgeons may not be far off). Instead, they perform routine and laborious tasks, freeing nurses up to attend to patients with immediate needs. This is one industry where it seems the integration of robots will lead to collaboration, not replacement.

51. What does the author say about Japan?

- A)It delivers the best medications for the elderly.
- B)It takes the lead in providing robotic care.
- C)It provides retraining for registered nurses.
- D)It sets the trend in future robotics technology.

52. What do we learn about the robot Terapio?

- A)It has been put to use in many Japanese hospitals.
- B)It provides specific individualized care to patients.
- C)It does not have much direct contact with patients.
- D)It has not revolutionized medical service in Japan.

53.What are telepresence robots designed to do?

- A)Directly interact with patients to prevent them from feeling lonely.
- B)Cater to the needs of patients for recovering their cognitive capacity.
- C)Closely monitor the patients' movements and conditions around the clock.
- D)Facilitate communication between patients and doctors or family members.

54.What is one special feature of the robot Actroid F?

- A)It interacts with patients just like a human companion.
- B)It operates quietly without patients realizing its presence.
- C)It likes to engage in everyday conversations with patients.
- D)It uses body language even more effectively than words.

55.What can we infer from the last paragraph?

- A)Doctors and surgeons will soon be laid off.
- B)The robotics industry will soon take off.
- C)Robots will not make nurses redundant.
- D)Collaboration will not replace competition.

阅读答案：BCDAC

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TEXT15

Children with attention problems in early childhood were 40% less likely to graduate from high school, says a new study from Duke University.

The study included 386 kindergarteners from schools in the Fast Track Project, a multi-site clinical trial in the U.S. that in 1991 began tracking how children developed across their lives.

With this study, researchers examined early academic attention and socio-emotional skills and how each contributed to academic success into young adulthood.

They found that early attention skills were the most consistent predictor of academic success, and that likability by peers also had a modest effect on academic performance.

By fifth grade, children with early attention difficulties had lower grades and reading achievement scores than their peers. As fifth-graders, children with early attention problems obtained average reading scores at least 3% lower than their contemporaries' and grades at least 8% lower than those of their peers. This was after controlling for IQ, socio-economic status and academic skills at school entry.

Although these may not seem like large effects, the impact of early attention problems continued throughout the children's academic careers. Lower reading achievement scores and grades in fifth grade contributed to reduced grades in middle school and thereby contributed to a 40% lower high school graduation rate.

"The children we identified as having attention difficulties were not diagnosed with attention deficit hyperactivity disorder(注意力缺乏多动症)(ADHD), although some may have had the disorder. Our findings suggest that even more modest attention dean of Duke's Trinity College of Arts & Sciences, whose research has focused on ADHD and interventions to improve academic performance in children with attention difficulties.

Social acceptance by peers in early childhood also predicted grades in fifth grade. Children not as liked by their first-grade peers had slightly lower grades in fifth grade, while those with higher social acceptance had higher grades.

"This study shows the importance of so-called 'non-cognitive' or soft skills in contributing to children's positive peer relationships, which, in turn, contribute to their academic success," said Kenneth Dodge, director of the Duke Center for Child and Family Policy.

The results highlight the need to develop effective early interventions to help those with attention problems stay on track academically and for educators to encourage positive peer relationships, the researchers said.

"We're learning that student success requires a more comprehensive approach, one that incorporates not only academic skills but also social, self-regulatory and attention skills," Dodge said. "If we neglect any of these areas, the child's development lags. If we attend to these areas, a child's success may reinforce itself with positive feedback loops."

46. What is the focus of the new study from Duke University?

A)The contributors to children's early attention.

B) The predictors of children's academic success.

C) The factors that affect children's emotional well-being.

D) The determinants of children's development of social skills.

47. How did the researchers ensure that their findings are valid?

A)By attaching equal importance to all possible variables examined.

B)By collecting as many typical samples as were necessary.

C)By preventing them from being affected by factors not under study.

D)By focusing on the family background of the children being studied.

48. What do we learn from the findings of the Duke study?

A)Modest students are generally more attentive than their contemporaries.

B)There are more children with attention difficulties than previously thought.

C)Attention deficit hyperactivity disorder accounts for most academic failures.

D)Children's academic performance may suffer from even slight inattention.

49. What does the Duke study find about children better accepted by peers?

A)They do better academically.

B)They are easy to get on with.

C)They are teachers' favorites.

D)They care less about grades.

50. What can we conclude from the Duke study?

A)Children's success is related to their learning environment.

B)School curriculum should cover a greater variety of subjects.

C)Social skills are playing a key role in children's development.

D)An all-round approach should be adopted in school education.

阅读答案：BCDAD

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TEXT16

On Jan.9,2007, Steve Jobs formally announced Apple's "revolutionary mobile phone"—a device that combined the functionality of an iPod, phone and Internet communication into a single unit, navigated by touch.

It was a huge milestone in the development of smartphones, which are now owned by a majority of American adults and are increasingly common across the globe.

As smartphones have multiplied, so have questions about their impact on how we live and how we work. Often the advantages of convenient, mobile technology are both obvious and taken for granted, leaving more subtle topics for concerned discussion: Are smartphones disturbing children's sleep? Is an inability to get away from work having a negative impact on health? And what are the implications for privacy?

But today, on the 10th anniversary of the iPhone, let's take a moment to consider a less obvious advantage: the potential for smartphone technology to revolutionize behavioral science. That's because, for the first time in human history, a large proportion of the species is in continuous contact with technology that can record key features of an individual's behavior and environment.

Researchers have already begun to use smartphones in social scientific research, either to query people regularly as they engage in their normal lives or to record activity using the device's built-in sensors. These studies are confirming, challenging and extending what's been found using more traditional approaches, in which people report how they behaved in real life or participate in relatively short and artificial laboratory-based tasks.

Such studies are just first steps. As more data are collected and methods for analysis improve, researchers will be in a better position to identify how different experiences, behaviors and environments relate to each other and evolve over time, with the potential to improve people's productivity and wellbeing in a variety of domains. Beyond revealing population-wide patterns, the right combination of data and analysis can also help individuals identify unique characteristics of their own behavior, including conditions that could indicate the need for some form of intervention—such as an unusual increase in behaviors that signal a period of depression.

Smartphone-based data collection comes at an appropriate time in the evolution of psychological science. Today, the field is in transition, moving away from a focus on laboratory studies with undergraduate participants towards more complex, real-world situations studied with more diverse groups of people. Smartphones offer new tools for achieving these ambitions, providing rich data about everyday behaviors in a variety of contexts.

So here's another way in which smartphones might transform the way we live and work: by offering insights into human psychology and behavior and, thus, supporting smarter social science.

51. What does the author say about the negative impact of smartphones?

- A) It has been overshadowed by the positive impact.
- B) It has more often than not been taken for granted.
- C) It is not so obvious but has caused some concern.
- D) It is subtle but should by no means be overstated.

52. What is considered a less obvious advantage of smartphone technology?

- A) It systematically records real human interactions.
- B) It helps people benefit from technological advances.
- C) It brings people into closer contact with each other.
- D) It greatly improves research on human behavior.

53. What characterizes traditional psychological research?

- A) It is based on huge amounts of carefully collected data.
- B) It relies on lab observations and participants' reports.
- C) It makes use of the questionnaire method.
- D) It is often expensive and time-consuming.

54. How will future psychological studies benefit individuals?

- A) By helping them pin down their unusual behaviors.
- B) By helping them maintain a positive state of mind.
- C) By helping them live their lives in a unique way.
- D) By helping them cope with abnormal situations.

55. What do we learn about current psychological studies?

- A) They are going through a period of painful transition.
- B) They are increasingly focused on real-life situations.
- C) They are conducted in a more rigorous manner.
- D) They are mainly targeted towards undergraduates.

阅读答案：CDBAB

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长篇阅读方法：

The Benefits of Solitude

A) I can be a reluctant socialiser. I'm sometimes secretly pleased when social plans are called off. I get restless a few hours into a hangout. I even once went on a free 10-day silent meditation (冥想) retreat-not for the meditation, but for the silence.

B) So I can relate to author Anneli Rufus, who wrote in *Party of One: The Loners' Manifesto*: "When parents on TV shows punished their kids by ordering them to go to their rooms, I was confused. I loved my room. Being there behind a locked door was a treat. To me a punishment was being ordered to play games with my cousin Louis."

C) Unsocial tendencies like these are often far from ideal. Abundant research shows the harms of social isolation, considered a serious public health problem in countries that have rapidly ageing populations (though talk of a 'loneliness epidemic' may be exaggerated). In the UK, the Royal College of General Practitioners says that loneliness has the same risk level for premature death as diabetes. Strong social connections are important for cognitive functioning, motor function and a smoothly running immune system.

D) This is especially clear from cases of extreme social isolation. Examples of people kept in captivity, children kept isolated in abusive orphanages, and prisoners kept in solitary confinement all show how prolonged solitude can lead to hallucinations (幻觉) and other forms of mental instability.

E) But these are severe and involuntary cases of aloneness. For those of us who just prefer plenty of alone time, emerging research suggests some good news: there are upsides to being alone-for both our work lives and our emotional well-being.

F) Solitude is a time for reflection, for thinking about things more deeply. In a world increasingly focused on speed and competitiveness, solitude is

precious and something to be treasured. And there are benefits in learning to love your solitude.

G) One key benefit of solitude is improved creativity. Gregory Feist, who focuses on the psychology of creativity at California's San Jose State University, has defined creativity as thinking or activity with two key elements: originality and usefulness. He has found that personality traits commonly associated with creativity are openness (receptiveness to new thoughts and experiences), self-confidence, and autonomy—which may include "a lack of concern for social norms" and "a preference for being alone". In fact, Feist's research on both artists and scientists shows that one of the most prominent features of creative folks is their lesser interest in socialising.

H) One reason for this is that such people are likely to spend sustained time alone working on their craft. Plus, Feist says, many artists "are trying to make sense of their internal world and a lot of internal personal experiences that they're trying to give expression and meaning to through their art." Solitude allows for the reflection and observation necessary for that creative process.

I) A recent justification of these ideas came from University at Buffalo psychologist Julie Bowker, who researches social withdrawal. Social withdrawal is usually categorised into three types: shyness caused by fear or anxiety; avoidance, from a dislike of socialising; and unsociability, from a preference for solitude. A paper by Bowker and her colleagues was the first to show that a type of social withdrawal could have a positive effect—they found that creativity was linked specifically to unsociability. They also found that unsociability had no correlation with aggression (shyness and avoidance did). This was significant because while previous research had suggested that unsociability might be harmless, Bowker and colleagues' paper showed that it could actually be beneficial. Unsociable people are likely to be "having just enough interaction," Bowker says. "They have a preference for being alone, but

they also don't mind being with others."

J) Still, it turns out that solitude is important for more than creativity. It's commonly believed that leaders need to be sociable. But this depends, among other things, on the personalities of their employees. One 2011 study showed that in branches of a pizza chain where employees were more passive, outgoing bosses were associated with higher profits. But in branches where employees were more active, introverted (内向的) leaders were more effective. One reason for this is that introverted people are less likely to feel threatened by strong personalities and suggestions. They're also more likely to listen.

K) Since ancient times, meanwhile, people have been aware of a link between isolation and mental focus. After all, cultures with traditions of religious hermits (隐士) believe that solitude is important for enlightenment. Recent research has given us a better understanding of why. One benefit of unsociability is the brain's state of active mental rest, which goes hand-in-hand with the stillness of being alone. When another person is present, your brain can't help but pay some attention. This can be a positive distraction. But it's still a distraction.

L) Daydreaming in the absence of such distractions activates the brain's default-mode network. Among other functions, this network helps to consolidate memory and understand others' emotions. Giving free rein to a wandering mind not only helps with focus in the long term but strengthens your sense of both yourself and others. Paradoxically, therefore, periods of solitude actually help when it comes time to socialise once more. And the occasional absence of focus ultimately helps concentration in the long run.

M) A more recent advocate of thoughtful and productive solitude is Susan Cain, author of *Quiet: The Power of Introverts in a World That Can't Stop Talking* and founder of Quiet Revolution, a company that promotes quiet and introvert-friendly workplaces. "These days, we tend to believe that creativity emerges from a decidedly unreserved socialising process, but in

fact it requires sustained attention and deep focus," she says. "Also, humans are such absorbent social beings that when we surround ourselves with others, we automatically take in their opinions and aesthetics. To truly chart our own path or vision, we have to be willing to isolate ourselves, at least for some period of time."

N) Still, the line between useful solitude and dangerous isolation can be blurry. "Almost anything can be adaptive and maladaptive, depending on how extreme they get," Feist says. A disorder has to do with dysfunction. If someone stops caring about people and cuts off all contact, this could point to an irrational neglect of social relations. But creative unsociability is a far cry from this. In fact, Feist says, "there's a real danger with people who are never alone." "It's hard to examine one's own thoughts, feelings and motives, to be self-aware, and fully relaxed unless you have occasional solitude. In addition, introverts tend to have fewer but stronger friendships-which has been linked to greater happiness."

O) As with many things, quality reigns over quantity. Nurturing a few solid relationships without feeling the need to constantly populate your life with endless chatting ultimately may be better for you.

P) Thus, if your personality tends toward unsociability, you shouldn't feel the need to change. Of course, that comes with qualifications. But as long as you have regular social contact, you are choosing solitude rather than being forced into it, you have at least a few good friends and your solitude is good for your well-being or productivity, there's no point agonising over how to fit a square personality into a round hole.

36.Lots of research demonstrates that being socially isolated is harmful to the elderly.

37.Being alone enables artists to think and observe, which is a must for their creation.

38.To one writer, being forced to play with others was a penalty while being kept alone in a room was quite a pleasure.

39.Recent research shows for the first time that there is a specific link between being creative and being unsociable.

40.We must be willing to stay alone at least for some time in order to plot our own course.

41.According to new research, for people who prefer being alone, solitude can be beneficial to their work lives and emotional health.

42.It may turn out to be better for one to cultivate a few steady relationships than to busy themselves socialising.

43.Allowing your mind to wander freely is conducive to sharpening your focus in the long run.

44.Research conducted on artists and scientists indicates that creative people are less interested in hanging out with others.

45.According to Feist,you will have difficulty knowing yourself if you do not stay alone occasionally.

上一篇长篇 阅读答案: CHBIM EOLGN

Do You Know When to Quit Wisely?

[A] Projects, relationships, and jobs don't always work out as planned—and it's not always clear when to give up. We've all repeatedly heard the saying that “quitters never win,” but sometimes the best decision is to cut our losses.

[B] Think about that relationship you held on to even after it had run its course or the job you stayed in despite your boss making you miserable. Many of us try to hold onto the last ray of hope, thinking we can make it work, whatever “it” is. And while perseverance is generally an excellent quality, it may also incline you to over-invest in something that is no longer a good idea.

[C] As an executive coach, I work with numerous passionate and hard-working leaders who don't want to “quit.” But the smartest leaders learn to discern the difference between quitting too soon and holding onto something that they shouldn't.

[D] We are all susceptible to the sunk-cost delusion, an unconscious bias that leads us to persist in an endeavor we have already invested time, effort, or money into—even when abandoning it would be more beneficial. If quitting is “not your thing,” you may be especially susceptible to this bias.

[E] The sunk-cost delusion causes us to overly worry about what we'll lose if we move on and not think enough about the costs of not moving on. To offset this bias, deliberately refocus your thinking on the gains so you can more objectively weigh the alternatives. Ask yourself: What might I gain by cutting my losses now?

[F] The illusion of control can also interfere with our best judgment. Especially when combined with an “I’m not a quitter” mentality, feeling like we have more control over an event or person than we do puts us at risk of doubling down when we should pull out.

[G] To counteract this bias, make a simple two-column list of what's in your control and what's not. While you may be able to influence other people, you can't force them to change or go your way.

[H] Getting clear on these boundaries is essential to making a quality decision. Expending effort and emotion on things you can't control can be both draining and disempowering.

[I] Research indicates that people link their self-identity and social status to their commitments. Withdrawing from one can feel like a threat to our identity.

[J] Take my client Ryan, a leader at a technology company. Ryan had invested two years in a design project that wasn't delivering, but the thought of abandoning it was hard to bear. She stated, “The thing is, I'm not a quitter.” This fixed sense of self was clouding her judgment.

[K] To overcome this, recall your other positive traits. When I asked Ryan what other qualities she needed for decision making, she replied, “Discernment and bravery.”

[L] Examine your situation through these new lenses. It's also helpful to seek external sources of information, rather than relying solely on your instincts.

[M] Ideally, seek out people who are less invested in your decision than

you are. Ask someone removed from the ups and downs of your situation: “How would you manage this?”

[N] Alternately, seek out hard data that illuminates your real chance of success. Use numbers to remove yourself from the "love" you have for an idea and consider factors that predict success.

[O] When things don't turn out as imagined, we can become overly self-critical. The most effective strategy is to practice self-compassion, which increases resilience and helps develop a growth mindset.

[P] Focus on what you can learn from the situation. Ryan recognized she had developed new leadership skills from her project; despite dropping it, she was grateful for the experience.

[Q] Undeniably, perseverance can help us succeed. But for your wellbeing, it's important to learn how to distinguish quitting too soon from clinging to a losing course. Letting go will free up your energy for new opportunities.

36. Feeling like they have more control over something or someone than they do, people get more committed to their pursuit when they should give up.

37. If you regard yourself as one who never quits, you may end up trapped in your course of action.

38. One of the author's clients found it hard to give up a design project, in which she had put in a lot of time and effort.

39. The author suggests that one should direct their thoughts to the gains of quitting timely so as to move on.

40. When making a decision, you'd better ask for opinions of those who have less stake in your decision.

41. For people associating their identity with their commitments, quitting can feel like their identity is threatened.

42. People who regard highly the quality of making wise decisions do not feel good when they make a bad one.

43. The wisest leaders learn to distinguish between giving up too soon and sticking with something irrationally.

44. When people are thinking of an endeavor, they should dig out reliable data that tells them how likely they are to succeed.

45. Having a clear view of what's in your control and what's not is vital to making a good decision regarding whether to give up or stick it out.

上一篇 · 答案 F KJEM IOCNH

The History and Meaning of Colored Traffic Lights

[A] Timed traffic lights are set according to schedules that are supposed to coordinate with peak traffic hours. Cities need to monitor and update signal light time schedules at least every two years to keep these systems effective. In Los Angeles, California, an ambitious project to go a step further and synchronize every red light in Los Angeles cost over 400 million dollars. Ask a resident of the city and they are likely to agree that saving time on the road is well worth it. If implemented nationwide, synchronization could shave 10% off traffic congestion and 20% off air pollution. Congestion costs time, money, and lives. Big data can help improve how millions of people safely share the road. However, none of this would be possible without the traffic light!

[B] The first traffic light was invented in London in the 1860's, but it was hardly recognizable—or effective. It had been adapted from the railroad signal system by a railway manager, John Peak Knight, in 1868. The railroads used red gas lights at night to signal stops and green gas lights during the daytime. Knight installed a similar gas light, semaphore (臂板信号) system near London's Westminster Bridge in December of 1868.

[C] The life of the first traffic light signal was short-lived. A gas leak caused one of the signal lights to explode on its police officer operator within a month of being installed.

[D] Automating traffic signals stalled after the London incident. Forty years passed before cars crowding city streets urged the development of traffic lights in the United States. London would not see another traffic light until 1929.

[E] The United States is a car culture like no other country. Unlike most European cities that started urban planning when horses were high-tech,

many cities in the United States were designed around urban sprawl, suburban tracts, and motor cars.

[F] As traffic and cities grew, so did the race to solve growing traffic problems. The first traffic signals were semaphores. Semaphores are towers with moving arms signaling for traffic to stop or go. They could be manual or automatic. There was no consistent design. Various models were invented and put into place in cities as the need arose.

[G] In 1912, Lester Wire was a police officer exhausted by traffic at Main Street and 200 South. He developed a manually switched stop light. The four-sided box, raised on a ten-foot pole, looked like a birdhouse and was operated manually by an officer. The officer would flip a switch to change between the dipped red and green lights.

[H] Like the 1910 semaphore, the first electric signal used words. However, the words were no longer written on arms that raised and fell. The words “stop” or “move” were on lights. The posts lit up on each of four corner-posts around an intersection. It was not automated, though. A booth with an operator was required to flip the switches.

[I] The system allowed police officers to move from the middle of the street to a corner. From that vantage (有利地点), an officer could oversee the crowd. If an emergency vehicle came, the officer could flip a switch and clear the intersection by triggering all red lights. The emergency vehicle could now pass effortlessly. Finally, in San Francisco the first red and green electric light system that could be operated automatically (or manually) was introduced in 1917.

[J] In 1920, the first three-color light system was introduced in Detroit—also known as Motor City, USA. The evolution of traffic light

signals could not have a more appropriate context than Motor City. Ford Motor Company was founded in Detroit in 1903 (and other motor companies followed). Ford made cars affordable for more common people, rather than the wealthy, by creating larger scale factory production.

[K] Stop and go were insufficient for the new volumes of cars zooming through intersections. Streets were full of new numbers of cars in addition to delivery wagons, bustling crowds, bicycles, horse-drawn carriages, and street cars. The introduction of the cautionary yellow light helped increase driver safety, decreasing accidents that come from running red lights.

[L] Stop lights were incredibly important in chaotic city streets. Crosswalks weren't even introduced until 1951. The first pedestrian fatality in the United States was in 1899.

[M] The development of the modern traffic light may have started in London, but it grew up in the United States. In Cleveland, an African-American inventor named Garrett Morgan came up with an affordable, patented traffic signal. The yellow light made intersections safer than the old stop and go system. The new design was inexpensive enough that it allowed the installation of a lot more lights.

[N] Morgan sold the patent to General Electric—and the spread of the traffic light was green lighted. Green means go. It is that simple, but it's still best to check both ways for oncoming traffic that may not be paying attention or is running the light. Yellow means slow down and prepare to stop. It does not mean full-throttle (全速) ahead. While you may get away with gunning it into the intersection, running a yellow can lead to tickets and dangerous accidents. Red lights are a clear and consistent warning to

stop. Even where right turns are allowed on red lights, you must come to a complete stop before turning right. New York City does not allow a right on red.

[O] Red arrows mean you cannot turn right on a red in most states. The green arrow, in these cases, is the only time you can make the turn. However, you can take a right on a red arrow after a full stop in states like Illinois, Kansas, Louisiana, Maryland, Michigan, etc.

[P] Flashing Red is the same as a stop sign, generally used at four-way intersections where there is minimal traffic. When arriving at a flashing red light, make a full and complete stop. Flashing Yellow lights mean yield or signal caution. There are no all-direction flashing yellow lights, since it is prohibited in the United States.

[Q] Flashing Yellow Arrows are part of a four-signal traffic light. When a flashing yellow arrow is shown, you can take the turn after yielding to pedestrians and traffic. Steady Yellow Arrows maintain the normal yellow light caution. In a four-signal system, the steady yellow arrow is a signal that the yield period is ending. The red arrow is about to start.

[R] Traffic light meaning is fairly consistent across the board with various deviations. Green means it's safe to proceed. Yellow means caution and yield. Red means danger and stop. Always drive defensively and obey traffic signals.

题目

36. Upon seeing a flashing yellow arrow, a driver should let pedestrians and traffic pass first before taking the turn.

37. The red and green automatic traffic light system originated in an American city.

- 38. Residents of an American city tend to share the opinion that time saved on the road justifies the cost of upgrading its traffic light system.
- 39. Mass production of cars made it possible for ordinary people to buy them.
- 40. What a traffic light means is almost the same everywhere despite some variations.
- 41. Pedestrian crossings came into being only in the mid-twentieth century.
- 42. People raced to address increasing traffic problems along with the expansion of cities and traffic.
- 43. When the warning yellow light was introduced, driving became safer and traffic accidents reduced.
- 44. The signal system on the railroad served as the basis for the first traffic light.
- 45. Even though a green light signals “go” , attention should be paid to traffic on either side in case some driver is being careless or ignoring a red light.

Q I A J R L F K B N

The Robots Are Coming to the Dining Room

[A] Unlike most chefs, Flippy is not afraid of hard work. Since last summer, that has meant 11am until 7pm shifts at Caliburger in Pasadena, California. These are long hours of repetitive work, where the boss demands absolute consistency. But you won't hear Flippy complain. Flippy is a robot: a cloud-connected mechanical arm with 3D thermal scanners for eyes—that can flip burgers or fry 80 baskets of food an hour, monitor that food and even clean up afterwards.

[B] Flippy was created by Miso Robotics, part of the Cali Group. Cali creates new machines that it road-tests in its Caliburger restaurants across the world. Also in California, Bear Robotics has developed a self-guiding robot, Penny, which has so far served 40,000 diners.

[C] Ten years ago, robot-chefs and waiters were pure science fiction. Today, they are a reality at plausible investment prices. Fully automated burger restaurants managed with minimal human oversight—where customers order at screens, pay electronically and eat food cooked and delivered by robots—are now a possibility.

[D] In an industry keen to slash labour costs and increase profits, further automation seems inevitable. After an eight-month test at Kang Nam Tofu House, Bear Robotics credited Penny with driving a 28% increase in sales. Meanwhile, self-ordering screens at McDonald's yielded a reported 30% rise in order values.

[E] Personalisation is key to the appeal of this technology. Soon, when you log into a restaurant app, it will be able to use your data and purchasing history to recommend dishes—factoring in everything from the weather to your mood via facial recognition.

[F] “Digital is allowing us to create new versions of restaurants,” says Tom Weaver, CEO at Flyt. Technology can allow us to make personal choices instead of a one-size-fits-all menu. He points to the Helsinki pop-up Take-in, where diners ordered dishes from various delivery services within a full-service environment.

[G] “It’ll probably be a very long time before we see a five-star robot-chef,” says Noel Sharkey, professor of AI and robotics. Apart from the AI creativity gap, great cooking involves a subtle understanding of ingredients and delicate cooking that would be enormously challenging for robots.

[H] Currently, robots have limited functionality. At the robot-powered US pizza-delivery company Zume, the more difficult jobs, such as topping pizzas, are still done by humans. But Moley, which will launch soon, offers sophistication. Modelled on the movements of a MasterChef winner, its robotic arms are programmed to prepare dishes from raw ingredients.

[I] For now, kitchen technology like QSR Automations is less glamorous but practical. Rather than a chef shouting orders, the system automatically distributes orders across screens, telling chefs when to start cooking each dish so the entire plate comes together at the right time.

[J] The restaurant industry is currently suffering a severe shortage of skilled chefs—a deficit of 11,000. “Automation systems designed to make the process more idiot-proof are trying to bridge that gap,” says Stefan Chomka, editor of Restaurant magazine.

[K] Online booking has been a success, and automated at-table ordering is the next landmark. However, early adopters may experience “lower

than expected” acceptance as customers get used to the interface.

[L] Embarrassing failures in restaurant tech frequently hit the headlines, such as the TGI Fridays drone that injured a photographer. Chomka warns that technology could miss the mark if it only offers solutions to problems that don't really exist.

[M] The attachment to the human art of hospitality will be heartening for staff who see automation as a threat to jobs. Unions are urging MPs to ensure automation does not just benefit a wealthy few like previous industrial revolutions.

[N] The industry principle is that automation will allow it to redeploy staff more effectively. McDonald's notes that self-order screens create more demand for front-of-house staff. Caliburger even has a programme to retrain staff as robot engineers or “chef techs.”

[O] Ultimately, the chance to reduce overheads will attract big brands. Over the next 10 years, jobs will go in conventional bricks-built restaurants, partly because automation will boost their rival: delivery. Robot food deliveries via small, 4mph ground robots are seen as the future.

[P] Combined with machine learning, robot fleets could deliver almost instantly. Intelligent assistants might hear you say "Let's have pizza," and 10 minutes later, the food is at your door. The robots are coming.

36. It is now possible to fully automate a burger restaurant with little human supervision.

37. At a robot-powered US company, complicated tasks still have to be performed by humans.

38. More automation appears to be a certainty in industries eager to cut labour costs and raise profits.

39. There are often front-page reports of failures in technological innovation of the restaurant industry.

40. Robot-chef Flippy does not fear laborious work, nor does it make any complaints.

41. Digital technology makes it possible for businesses to innovate restaurant models.

42. Fondness for human warmth in catering to customers will give hope to employees who are afraid of losing jobs to robots.

43. There is an acute shortage of experienced chefs in the catering industry and automated cooking is expected to fill the gap.

44. Over the coming decade, many jobs in traditional restaurants will disappear due to automation and delivery.

45. According to an expert in AI and robotics, it may be quite some time before a master robot-chef appears.



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上一篇答案: CHDLAFMJOG

Saving Our Planet

A) In the long view, the human relationship with forests has been one of brutal destruction, but even it carries elements of slow hope. In the Middle Ages, there was no shortage of timber in most parts of the world, and few saw cutting down forests as a problem. Yet in 1548 the people of Venice estimated that an important timber supply would last only 30 years at their current rate of usage-but different forest management would make it possible to meet the demand for many centuries to come. The idea of preserving resources came out of a concern for the future: a fear of using up resources faster than they could be replenished (补充).

B)

C) Economic interests were at the core of this understanding of trees and forests. It would take more than three centuries before scientists began to understand that timber production is not the only, and possibly not the most important, function of forests. The late 19th and early 20th century saw an increasing recognition that forests serve as habitats for countless animal and plant species that all rely on each other. They take over protective functions against soil erosion and landslides (塌方); they make a significant contribution to the water balance as they prevent surface runoff; they filter dirt particles, greenhouse gases and radioactive substances from the air; they produce oxygen; they provide spaces for recreation and they preserve historic and prehistoric remains. As a result, forests around the world have been set aside as parks or wilderness areas.

C) Recent years have seen a big change in our view of forests. Peter Wohlleben's book *The Hidden Life of Trees* (2015), an international bestseller, suggests that trees can warn each other of danger through a "wood wide web" of roots and fungi (真菌). support each other through sharing of nutrients and information, and they even keep ancient stumps

alive by feeding them solutions of sugars. Such insights have made us aware of deep ecological relationships between humans and the more-than-human world.

D) Awareness of ecologies is a recent phenomenon. It was not until the 1940s that the concept of the "environment" embracing all living and nonliving things developed. In the 1970s, the term "environment" gained currency, becoming widely adopted in the English and Romance languages, and as "Umwelt" ("surrounding world") in German. The emergence of the idea led to the rise of environmental agencies, regulations and environmental studies, and to environmental science as new, integrated academic disciplines. It was in 1956 that the very first bachelor of science in environmental studies was awarded, at the State University of New York College of Forestry at Syracuse. Since the 1970s with the rise of "environmentalism"-environmental studies programmes have sprung up at hundreds of universities. There is (slow) hope in the fact that scholars from many different disciplines have adopted the term "environment" over the past decades. They are exploring intricate connections within and between complex ecologies, as well as the impact that human environment-making (through techno-industrial, economic and other manipulative developments) has had on the biosphere.

E) The rise of the idea of the environment and a scholarly understanding of ecological processes has influenced new technologies and also politics. We have come to ask questions about vulnerability and risk, world ecologies, and the relationship between nature and power. The search for an adequate response to climate change occupies centre stage in international diplomacy.

A) Social and environmental activists, scientists and indigenous groups

have called the Paris Agreement of the United Nations Climate Change Conference in December 2015 insufficient, weak, or compromised. To some extent, they are right: climate change has already destroyed tens of thousands of livelihoods, and the situation will worsen in the near future for millions of mostly poorer people, who will join the ranks of those who have already been displaced by climate change and extreme weather events. But the Paris Conference nevertheless marked a historic step toward the recognition of the need for action on climate change, the cutting of carbon emissions, and world cooperation. There were 195 nations that came to the table in Paris and agreed to limits on emissions. Historically, nothing comparable had happened prior to this. Before the 20th century, a handful of scientists had been interested in the theoretical relationship between greenhouse gases and climate change, but only the empirical evidence accumulated since the late 20th century established a clear connection between the burning of fossil fuels and a vastly accelerated rise in global temperatures.

B)

C) The current crisis is not the first that humans have encountered, and a look at the struggles with pollution in recent history reveals transformations that once seemed unimaginable. The "London fog" that came to define the capital through British novels and thrillers is in reality smog or smoke, a legacy of industrialisation. After a century of ignorance, London was hit by the Great Smog of December 1952-the worst air-pollution event in the history of the United Kingdom which caused the deaths of approximately 12,000 people. Shortly thereafter, public initiatives and political campaigns led to strict regulations and new laws, including the Clean Air Act (1956). Today, London has effectively reduced traffic emissions through the introduction of a Congestion Charge Zone in 2003, and an Ultra Low Emission Zone in 2019.

D) Scientific evidence that we are living in an era of climate change,

resource exhaustion and potential ecological disaster is overwhelming. How do we motivate a public exhausted by never-ending scenarios of doom and disaster, when the challenges seem so huge and so impossible to solve? Statistics about extinction and the gloom of decline will not in themselves get us out of our often self-created ecological traps: instead, they are more likely to result in paralysis and inaction.

E) We need stories and histories of change and transformation: ecological stories that make us confront the fact that human power is potentially destructive, and that the survival of our species on this planet depends on the preservation of soil and water, and the habitats and ecological systems.

F) It is time that we showed successes and accelerations in ecological awareness, action and restoration: stories that include past successes and future visions about the rise of urban gardening and of renaturalised riverscapes, of successful protests against polluted air and water, of the rise of regional markets and slow food, and the planting of trees around the globe, of initiatives and enterprises that work towards ecological restoration. The reality of ecological curses seems far greater than the power of the hopes left at the bottom of Pandora's box. But if we believe that nothing can be changed, then we are giving up our opportunity to ad.

K) Today's saving powers will not come from a *deus ex machina* (解围之神). In an ever-more complex and synthetic world, our saving powers won't come from a single source, and certainly not from a too-big-to-fail approach or from those who have been drawn into the whirlpool of our age of speed. Hope can work as a wake up call. It acknowledges setbacks. The concept of slow hope suggests that we can't expect things to change overnight. If the ever-faster exhaustion of natural resources (in ecological terms) and the "shrinking of the present" (in social terms) are urgent problems of humans, then cutting down on exhaustive practices and

working towards a "stretching of the present" will be ways to move forward.

36.Climate change has wrought havoc on the lives of tens of thousands of people.

37.It took scientists a long time to realise that the function of forests goes far beyond providing humans with timber.

38.There is abundant evidence that we are now facing a possible ecological disaster.

39.Environmental science became academic disciplines only some sixty years ago.

40.Things cannot change overnight, but reducing the consumption of natural resources will help solve the ecological crisis.

41.Human perception of forests has undergone a tremendous change in the past years

42.Recent history shows reduction of pollution, once seemingly impossible, can actually be accomplished.

43.People began to consider preserving natural resources when they feared they would have nothing to use in the future

44.If we doubt our ability to reverse ecological deterioration, we are throwing away the chance to take action.

45. How to respond effectively to climate change has become the focus of international diplomacy.

阅读答案：FBH DJ KCGAE

词汇拓展：请将文中生词整理誊写至下面区域

生词	文中搭配	中文释义

随写区



手机扫码观看/分享

The Doctor Will Skype You Now

A)Fazila is a young woman that has been dealing with eczema (湿疹), a common skin condition, for the past five years, but never got it treated. The nearest hospital is an hour away, by boat and bus, and her skin condition didn't seem serious enough to make the trek, so she ignored it—until a new technology brought the doctor to her. Fazila lives on one of the remote river islands in northern Bangladesh. These islands are low-lying temporary sand islands that are continuously formed and destroyed through sand buildup and erosion. They are home to over six million people, who face repeated displacement from flooding and erosion—which may be getting worse because of climate change-and a range of health risks, including poor nutrition, malaria (疟疾) and other water-borne diseases.

B)The most dangerous thing for these remote island dwellers is land erosion. The second is lack of access to medical supplies and doctors. There are no doctors within miles, and while child mortality and maternal death have gone down in the rest of the country, this is not the case for the islands. The medical situation is so bad that it really takes away from the quality of their life. Yet for many island inhabitants-some of Bangladesh's poorest-paying for health care is a costly ordeal. Victims of erosion lose their houses, agricultural land and jobs as farmers, fishermen and day laborers. Though government hospitals are free, many people hesitate to go, citing long commutes, endless lines and questionable diagnoses. For convenience's sake, one-third of rural households visit unqualified village doctors, who rely on unscientific methods of treatment, according to a 2016 study in the peer-reviewed journal Global Health Action.

C) On the islands, there's even a colloquial (口头的) expression for the idea of making medical care your lowest priority: It's known as "rog

pushai rakha" in Bengali, which roughly translates to "stockpiling their diseases"—waiting to seek medical attention until a condition becomes extremely serious. Now, a new virtual medical service called Teledaktar (TD) is trying to make health care more easily accessible. Every week, TD's medical operators travel to the islands by boat, carrying a laptop, a portable printer for prescriptions and tools to run basic medical screenings such as blood pressure, blood sugar, body temperature and weight. They choose an area of the island with the best Internet reception and set up a makeshift (临时凑合的) medical center which consists of plastic stools and small tables borrowed from the locals' homes, a tent in case of rain and a sheet that is strung up to give the patients privacy during their session.

D) Launched in October 2018, TD has eight centers in towns and villages across rural Bangladesh and on three islands. It is funded by a nonprofit organization founded by Bangladeshi entrepreneurs, finance and technology professionals. Inside the center, the laptop screen lights up to reveal Dr. Tina Mustahid, TD's head physician, live-streamed (网络直播) from the capital city of Dhaka for free remote medical consultations. Affectionately called Doctor Apa—"older sister" in Bengali—by her patients, she is one of three volunteer doctors at TD.

E) "I diagnose them through conversation," says Dr. Mustahid. "Sometimes it's really obvious things that local doctors don't have the patience to talk through with their patients. For example, a common complaint mothers come in with is that their children refuse to eat their meals. The mothers are concerned they are dealing with indigestion, but it's because they are feeding the children packaged chips which are cheap and convenient. I tell them it is ruining their appetite and ask them to cut back on unhealthy snacks." Dr. Mustahid says building awareness about health and nutrition is important for island patients who are cut off from

mainland resources.

F) Even off the islands, Bangladesh faces a critical deficit of health services. The country has half the doctors-per-person ratio recommended by the World Health Organization: roughly one doctor per 2,000 people, instead of one doctor per 1,000 people. And of those physicians, many are concentrated in cities: 70% of the country's population live in rural areas, yet less than 20% of health workers practice there. Over 70% of TD's 3,000 patients are female, in part because many are not comfortable speaking with local doctors who tend to be male. The rural women are mostly not literate or confident enough to travel on their own to the nearest town to visit medical facilities. Many have spent their entire lives rebuilding their homes when the islands flood. Early marriage and young motherhood, which are prevalent in these parts of Bangladesh, also contribute to the early onset of health problems.

G) For most TD patients on the islands, Dr. Mustahid is the first big-city doctor that they've ever consulted. TD doctors are not meant to treat serious illnesses or conditions that require a doctor to be physically present, such as pregnancy. But they can write prescriptions, diagnose common ailments—including digestive issues, joint pain, skin diseases, fever and the common cold—and refer patients to doctors at local hospitals. The visit is also an opportunity for the patients, especially women, to air their concerns about aging, motherhood and reproductive health according to Dr. Mustahid. The doctors also offer health, dietary and lifestyle advice where necessary, including insight on everything from recognizing postnatal (产后的) depression to daily exercise. Dr. Mustahid regularly recommends her patients to take a daily thirty-minute morning walk before the sun gets too intense.

H) After a few sessions about general health issues Fazila finally opened

up about something else that was bothering her: her persistent skin condition. It can get expensive to travel to the doctor, so usually the women living on the islands describe their illness to their husbands. The husbands then go to the pharmacy, try to describe the issue and return home with some random medicines. Nothing worked for Fazila until she started seeing Dr. Apa.

I) Other nonprofits are also starting to provide health services on the islands. A local non-governmental organization called Friendship operates floating boat hospitals that provide health services to islands all over Bangladesh, docking at each for two months at a time. Friendship also runs satellite clinics in which one doctor and one clinic aide who are residents of the community disperse health and hygiene information.

J) TD still has a few major challenges. Many residents complain the medicines they are prescribed are sometimes unaffordable, but the government isn't doing enough for them. Patients often ask why the medicine isn't free along with the consultation from the doctors. The organizations are linked to local pharmacies and offer discounts to the patients and make sure to prescribe the most cost-effective brands, but still many residents can't afford even that.

K) Nevertheless, TD's remote consultations seem to be popular: Of 3,000 patients, at least 200 have returned for follow-ups, according to TD. The reason, explains one resident, might be the simple gesture of treating the island inhabitants with respect. "Dr. Apa is patient," he says, "At government hospitals, the doctors treat us very badly, but here they listen to us, I can repeat myself many times and no one gets annoyed."

36. Some children on the remote islands won't eat their meals because they are fed cheap junk food.

37. Unlike other parts of Bangladesh, the number of women who die from giving birth remains high on the river islands.

38. One big problem many islanders have is that they can't afford the prescribed medicines, even with discounts offered.

39. TD is a virtual medical service financially supported by one of the nation's nonprofit organizations.

40. TD doctors are welcome to the islanders because they treat the sick with respect and patience.

41. Women islanders tend to have health problems early partly because they get married and give birth early.

42. TD doctors make weekly visits to the remote islands to provide services at a temporary medical center.

43. TD doctors provide the islanders with online diagnoses and treatments for common diseases.

44. The residents of the river islands have to keep moving their homes because of floods and land erosions.

45. Women islanders usually rely on their husbands to get some medicines for them without diagnoses and prescriptions.

阅读答案：EBJDK FCGAH

词汇拓展：请将文中生词整理誊写至下面区域

生词	文中搭配	中文释义

随写区

TEXT4

The Price of Oil and the Price of Carbon

[A]Fossil fuel prices are likely to stay "low for long." Notwithstanding important recent progress in developing renewable fuel sources, low fossil fuel prices could discourage further innovation in, and adoption of, cleaner energy technologies. The result would be higher emissions of carbon dioxide and other greenhouse gases.

[B]Policymakers should not allow low energy prices to derail the clean energy transition. Action to restore appropriate price incentives, notably through corrective carbon pricing, is urgently needed to lower the risk of irreversible and potentially devastating effects of climate change. That approach also offers fiscal benefits.

[C]Oil prices have dropped by over 60% since June 2014. A commonly held view in the oil industry is that "the best cure for low oil prices is low oil prices." The reasoning behind this saving is that low oil prices discourage investment in new production capacity, eventually shifting the oil supply curve backward and bringing prices back up as existing oil fields—which can be tapped at relatively low marginal cost—are depleted. In fact, in line with past experience, capital expenditure in the oil sector has dropped sharply in many producing countries, including the United States. The dynamic adjustment to low oil prices may, however, be different this time around.

[D]Oil prices are expected to remain lower for longer. The advent of new technologies has added about 4.2 million barrels per day to the crude oil market, contributing to a global over-supply. In addition, other factors are putting downward pressure on oil prices: change in the strategic behavior of the Organization of Petroleum Exporting Countries, the projected increase in Iranian exports, the scaling-down of global demand (especially from emerging markets), the long-term drop in petroleum consumption in the United States, and some displacement of oil by

substitutes. These likely persistent forces, like the growth of shale (页岩) oil, point to a “low for long” scenario. Futures markets, which show only a modest recovery of prices to around \$60 a barrel by 2019, support this view.

[E] Natural gas and coal—also fossil fuels—have similarly seen price declines that look to be long-lived. Coal and natural gas are mainly used for electricity generation, whereas oil is used mostly to power transportation, yet the prices of all these energy sources are linked. The North American shale gas boom has resulted in record low prices there. The recent discovery of the giant Zohr gas field off the Egyptian coast will eventually have impact on pricing in the Mediterranean region and Europe, and there is significant development potential in many other places, notably Argentina. Coal prices also are low, owing to over-supply and the scaling-down of demand, especially from China, which burns half of the world's coal.

[F]Technological innovations have unleashed the power of renewables such as wind, hydro, solar, and geothermal (地热). Even Africa and the Middle East, home to economies that are heavily dependent on fossil fuel exports, have enormous potential to develop renewables. For example, the United Arab Emirates has endorsed an ambitious target to draw 24% of its primary energy consumption from renewable sources by 2021.

[G]Progress in the development of renewables could be fragile, however, if fossil fuel prices remain low for long. Renewables account for only a small share of global primary energy consumption, which is still dominated by fossil fuels—30%each for coal and oil, 25%for natural gas. But renewable energy will have to displace fossil fuels to a much greater extent in the future to avoid unacceptable climate risks.

[H]Unfortunately, the current low prices for oil, gas, and coal may provide little incentive for research to find even cheaper substitutes for those fuels. There is strong evidence that both innovation and adoption of

cleaner technology are strongly encouraged by higher fossil fuel prices. The same is true for new technologies for alleviating fossil fuel emissions.

[I]The current low fossil fuel price environment will thus certainly delay the energy transition from fossil fuel to clean energy sources. Unless renewables become cheap enough that substantial carbon deposits are left underground for a very long time, if not forever, the planet will likely be exposed to potentially catastrophic climate risks.

[J]Some climate impacts may already be discernible. For example, the United Nations Children's Fund estimates that some 11 million children in Africa face hunger, disease, and water shortages as a result of the strongest El Niño (厄尔尼诺) weather phenomenon in decades. Many scientists believe that El Niño events, caused by warming in the Pacific, are becoming more intense as a result of climate change.

[K] Nations from around the world have gathered in Paris for the United Nations Climate Change Conference, COP 21, with the goal of a universal and potentially legally-binding agreement on reducing greenhouse gas emissions. We need very broad participation to fully address the global tragedy that results when countries fail to take into account the negative impact of their carbon emissions on the rest of the world. Moreover, non-participation by nations, if sufficiently widespread, can undermine the political will of participating countries to act.

[L] The nations participating at COP 21 are focusing on quantitative emissions-reduction commitments. Economic reasoning shows that the least expensive way for each country is to put a price on carbon emissions. The reason is that when carbon is priced, those emissions reductions that are least costly to implement will happen first. The International Monetary Fund calculates that countries can generate substantial fiscal revenues by eliminating fossil fuel subsidies and levying carbon charges that capture the domestic damage caused by emissions. A tax on upstream carbon sources is one easy way to put a price on carbon emissions,

although some countries may wish to use other methods, such as emissions trading schemes. In order to maximize global welfare, every country's carbon pricing should reflect not only the purely domestic damage from emissions, but also the damage to foreign countries.

[M] Setting the right carbon price will therefore efficiently align the costs paid by carbon users with the true social opportunity cost of using carbon. By raising relative demand for clean energy sources, a carbon price would also help align the market return to clean-energy innovation with its social return, spurring the refinement of existing technologies and the development of new ones. And it would raise the demand for technologies such as carbon capture and storage, spurring their further development. If not corrected by the appropriate carbon price, low fossil fuel prices are not accurately signaling to markets the true social profitability of clean energy. While alternative estimates of the damage from carbon emissions differ, and it's especially hard to reckon the likely costs of possible catastrophic climate events, most estimates suggest substantial negative effects.

[N] Direct subsidies to research and development have been adopted by some governments but are a poor substitute for a carbon price: they do only part of the job, leaving in place market incentives to over-use fossil fuels and thereby add to the stock of atmospheric greenhouse gases without regard to the collateral (附带的) costs.

[O] The hope is that the success of COP 21 opens the door to future international agreement on carbon prices. Agreement on an international carbon-price floor would be a good starting point in that process. Failure to address comprehensively the problem of greenhouse gas emissions, however, exposes all generations, present and future, to incalculable risks.

36.A number of factors are driving down the global oil prices not just for now but in the foreseeable future.

37.Pricing carbon proves the most economical way to reduce greenhouse gas emissions.

38.It is estimated that extreme weather conditions have endangered the lives of millions of African children

39.The prices of coal are low as a result of over-supply and decreasing demand.

40.Higher fossil fuel prices prove to be conducive to innovation and application of cleaner technology.

41.If fossil fuel prices remain low for a long time, it may lead to higher emissions of greenhouse gases.

42.Fossil fuels remain the major source of primary energy consumption in today's world.

43.Even major fossil fuel exporting countries have great potential to develop renewable energies.

44.Greenhouse gas emissions, if not properly dealt with, will pose endless risks for mankind.

45.It is urgent for governments to increase the cost of using fossil fuels to an appropriate level to lessen the catastrophic effects of climate change.

阅读答案：DLJEH AGFOB

词汇拓展：请将文中生词整理誊写至下面区域

生词	文中搭配	中文释义

随写区

TEXT5

Elite Math Competitions Struggle to Diversify Their Talent Pool

[A] Interest in elite high school math competitions has grown in recent years, and in light of last summer’s U.S. win at the International Math Olympiad (IMO)—the first for an American team in more than two decades—the trend is likely to continue.

[B] But will such contests, which are overwhelmingly dominated by Asian and white students from middle-class and affluent families, become any more diverse? Many social and cultural factors play roles in determining which promising students get on the path toward international math recognition. But efforts are in place to expose more black, Hispanic, and low-income students to advanced math, in the hope that the demographic pool of high-level contenders will eventually begin to shift and become less exclusive.

[C] “The challenge is if certain types of people are doing something, it’s difficult for other people to break into it,” said Po-Shen Loh, the head coach of last year’s winning U.S. Math Olympiad team. Participation grows through friends and networks and if “you realize that’s how they’re growing, you can start to take action” and bring in other students, he said.

[D] Most of the training for advanced-math competitions happens outside the confines of the normal school day. Students attend after-school clubs, summer camps, online forums and classes, and university-based “math circles”, to prepare for the competitions.

[E] One of the largest feeders for high school math competitions—including those that eventually lead to the IMO—is a middle school program called Math Counts. About 100,000 students around the country participate in the program’s competition series, which culminates in a national game-show-style contest held each May. The most recent one took place last week in Washington, D.C. Students join a team through their schools, which provide a volunteer coach and pay a

nominal fee to send students to regional and state competitions. The 224 students who make it to the national competition get an all-expenses- paid trip.

[F] Nearly all members of last year's winning U.S. IMO team took part in Math Counts as middle school students, as did Loh, the coach. "Middle school is an important age because students have enough math capability to solve advanced problems, but they haven't really decided what they want to do with their lives," said Loh. "They often get hooked then."

[G] Another influential feeder for advanced-math students is an online school called Art of Problem Solving, which began about 13 years ago and now has 15,000 users. Students use forums to chat, play games, and solve problems together at no cost, or they can pay a few hundred dollars to take courses with trained teachers. According to Richard Rusczyk, the company founder, the six U.S. team members who competed at the IMO last year collectively took more than 40 courses on the site. Parents of advanced- math students and Math Counts coaches say the children are on the website constantly.

[H] There are also dozens of summer camps—many attached to universities—that aim to prepare elite math students. Some are pricey—a three-week intensive program can cost \$4,500 or more—but most offer scholarships. The Math Olympiad Summer Training Program is a three-week math camp held by the Mathematical Association of America that leads straight to the international championship and is free for those who make it. Only about 50 students are invited based on their performance on written tests and at the USA Math Olympiad.

[I] Students in university towns may also have access to another lever for involvement in accelerated math: math circles. In these groups, which came out of an Eastern European tradition of developing young talent, professors teach promising K-12 students advanced mathematics for several hours after school or on weekends. The Los Angeles Math

Circle, held at the University of California, Los Angeles, began in 2007 with 20 students and now has more than 250. “These math circles cost nothing, or they’re very cheap for students to get involved in, but you have to know about them,” said Rusczyk. “Most people would love to get students from more underserved populations, but they just can’t get them in the door. Part of it is communication; part of it is transportation.”

[J] It’s no secret in the advanced-math community that diversity is a problem. According to Mark Saul, the director of competitions for the Mathematical Association of America, not a single African-American or Hispanic student---and only a handful of girls---has ever made it to the Math Olympiad team in its 50 years of existence. Many schools simply don’t prioritize academic competitions. “Do you know who we have to beat?” asked Saul. “The football team, the basketball team---that’s our competition for resources, student time, attention, school dollars, parent efforts, school enthusiasm.”

[K] Teachers in low-income urban and rural areas with no history of participating in math competitions may not know about advanced-math opportunities like Math Counts—and those who do may not have support or feel trained to lead them.

[L] But there are initiatives in place to try to get more underrepresented students involved in accelerated math. A New York City-based nonprofit called Bridge to Enter Mathematics runs a residential summer program aimed at getting underserved students, mostly black and Hispanic, working toward math and science careers. The summer after 7th grade, students spend three weeks on a college campus studying advanced math for seven hours a day. Over the next five years, the group helps the students get into other elite summer math programs, high-performing high schools, and eventually college. About 250 students so far have gone through the program, which receives funding from the Jack Kent Cooke Foundation.

[M] “If you look at a lot of low-income communities in the United

States, there are programs that are serving them, but they're primarily centered around 'Let's get these kids' grades up', and not around 'Let's get these kids access to the same kinds of opportunities as more-affluent kids,'" said Daniel Zaharopol, the founder and executive director of the program. "We're trying to create that pathway." Students apply to the program directly through their schools. "We want to reach parents who are not plugged into the system," said Zaharopol.

[N] In the past few years, Math Counts added two new middle school programs to try to diversify its participant pool---the National Math Club and the Math Video Challenge. Schools or teachers who sign up for the National Math Club receive a kit full of activities and resources, but there's no special teacher training and no competition attached.

[O] The Math Video Challenge is a competition, but a collaborative one. Teams of four students make a video illustrating a math problem and its real-world application. After the high-pressure Countdown round at this year's national Math Counts competition, in which the top 12 students went head to head solving complex problems in rapid fire, the finalists for the Math Video Challenge took the stage to show their videos. The demographics of that group looked quite different from those in the competition round---of the 16 video finalists, 13 were girls and eight were African-American students. The video challenge does not put individual students on the hot seat---so it's less intimidating by design. It also adds the element of artistic creativity to attract a new pool of students who may not see themselves as "math people".

36. Middle school is a crucial period when students may become keenly interested in advanced mathematics.

37. Elite high school math competitions are attracting more interest throughout the United States.

38. Math circles provide students with access to advanced-math training by university professors.

39. Students may take advantage of online resources to learn to solve math problems.

40. The summer program run by a nonprofit organization has helped many underserved students learn advanced math.

41. Winners of local contests will participate in the national math competition for free.

42. Many schools don't place academic competitions at the top of their priority list.

43. Contestants of elite high school math competitions are mostly Asian and white students from well-off families.

44. Some math training programs primarily focus on raising students' math scores.

45. Some intensive summer programs are very expensive but most of them provide scholarships.

阅读答案：FAIGL EJB MH

词汇拓展：请将文中生词整理誊写至下面区域

生词	文中搭配	中文释义

随写区

选词填空--最新真题

第一篇：AI 与人类智能 (AI and Human Intelligence)

Options:

A. accompanying | B. cognitive | C. domains | D. entertaining | E. evoking | F. hybrid | G. impetus | H. intuitive | I. once | J. oversee | K. redundant | L. stances | M. surpass | N. tentatively | O. vanish

We humans love to believe we are special, but science and technology have repeatedly proved this conviction wrong. People **26** thought that humans were the only animals to use tools, to form teams or to propagate culture, but science has shown that other animals do each of these things.

Meanwhile, technology has quashed, one by one, claims that **27** tasks require a human brain. The first adding machine was invented in 1623. This past year, a computer-generated work won an art contest. I believe the moment when computers meet and **28** human intelligence is on the horizon.

How will human intelligence and creativity be valued when machines become smarter and more creative than the brightest people? There will likely be a spectrum. In some **29**, people still value humans doing things, even if a computer can do it better. It's been a quarter of a century since a computer beat world champion Garry Kasparov, but human chess hasn't gone away.

In other fields, human skill will seem costly and **30**. Take illustration for example: most readers don't care whether the graphic **31** a magazine article was drawn by a person or a computer—they just want it to be relevant, new and perhaps **32**.

And, of course, this question isn't black or white. Many fields will be a **33**, where some humans find a lucky place, but most of the work is done by computers, like in manufacturing today, where much of the work is accomplished by robots, but some humans must be there to **34** the machines.

If history is any guide, it's almost certain that advances in AI will cause more jobs to **35**, that creative workers with human-only skills will become richer but fewer in number, and that those who own creative technology will become the new ultra-rich.

第二篇：口音与语言学 (The Nature of Accents)

Options:

A. affix | B. correlate | C. deviate | D. domains | E. influential | F. inherently | G. laymen | H. multiple | I. properties | J. reality | K. reciprocally | L. specimen | M. spectrum | N. synonym | O. unanimous

It's best to think of an accent as a distinct, systematic and rule-governed way of speaking. Accent is not a **26** for dialect, but it's related. Dialect is an umbrella term for the way a community pronounces words, creates words, and orders words; accent refers to that first part only.

Many **27** presume that there is a single standard way of speaking in each country, with one single standard accent, and that this perceived standard is **28** the best form of speech, but linguists often point out that the concept of a standard accent is better understood as an ideal rather than a **29**. In other words, no one speaks "standard English"; rather, it is an imagined way of using language that exists only in grammar and style books.

One reason linguists agree there is no one true standard is that, through the years, there have been **30** supposed standards, depending on time and place. The standard for English in British newsreels from the 1950s, for example, differs greatly from the standard found on American national news broadcasts today. In fact, there has never been a single standard that's been fully agreed upon—and broadcast outlets across the **31** have never consistently held to those standards anyway.

Even so, this idea of a standard accent is **32** and many workplace and educational environments perpetuate the idea that accents that **33** from the current standard are less appropriate, or even inappropriate. Scholars have found that southern U.S. accent features are more accepted in **34** such as government, law and service-oriented workplaces, but less accepted in the technology sector. The acceptability of nonstandard accents may **35** with differences in class and culture, with newer or higher prestige industries expecting more standard speech in the workplace.

第三篇：锻炼与健康 (Exercise and Health)

Options:

A. adolescents | B. arbitrarily | C. chronic | D. cognitive | E. concede | F. disregard | G. drop | H. ever | I. maneuver | J. mortality | K. particularly | L. patterns | M. refute | N. stereotype | O. vocal

By now, it is generally accepted that regular exercise comes with an assortment of health benefits for people who maintain the habit over time. But is it **26** too late to start?

New research looked at people who increased their exercise levels after their 40s beyond levels they had when they were younger and those individuals showed declines in their risk of early **27**, which were similar to those of people who exercised consistently throughout their lives. This was a **28** of 32% to 35% compared to people who did not exercise. Those who began exercising in middle age also saw reductions in their incidence of **29** diseases, such as heart disease and cancer, which were similar to the steady exercisers.

So why bother exercising consistently throughout your life? The authors of the study **30** that some might interpret the study's findings to mean that they can delay starting an exercise program but this would be a mistake. There are other benefits, both mental and physical, to staying consistently active that we should not **31**. These real health benefits include better **32** functioning and lowered risk of gaining weight. The latter is **33** important given the global obesity epidemic. In addition, experts assert that starting younger helps keep up those **34** later in life. It is ideal, then, for people to start exercising when they are children or **35**, and it is good to maintain an active lifestyle at all times regardless of your age.

--答案汇总

第一篇 (AI 与人类智能)

答案: I B M C K A D F J O

第二篇 (口音与语言学)

答案: N G F J H M E C D B

第三篇 (锻炼与健康)

答案: H J G C E F D K L A



手机扫码观看/分享

往年题目练习选词填空 1:

Small communities, with their distinctive character — where life is stable and intensely human— are disappearing. Some have 26 from the face of the earth, others are dying slowly, but all have 27 changes as they have come into contact with an 28 machine civilization. The merging of diverse peoples into a common mass has produced tension among members of the minorities and the majority alike.

The Old Order Amish, who arrived on American shores in colonial times, have 29 in the modern world in distinctive, small communities. They have resisted the homogenization 30 more successfully than others. In planting and harvest time one can see their bearded men working the fields with horses and their women hanging out the laundry in neat rows to dry. Many American people have seen Amish families, with the men wearing broad-brimmed black hats and the women in long dresses. In railway or bus 31 Although the Amish have lived with 32 America for over two and a half centuries, they have moderated its influence on their personal lives, their families» communities, and their values.

Small communities, with their distinctive character — where life is stable and intensely human— are disappearing. Some have 26 from the face of the earth, others are dying slowly, but all have 27 changes as they have come into contact with an 28 machine civilization. The merging of diverse peoples into a common mass has produced tension among members of the minorities and the majority alike.

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The Amish are often 33 by other Americans to be relics of the past who live a simple,inflexible life dedicated to inconvenient out-dated customs. They are seen as abandoning both modern 34 and the American dream of success and progress. But most people have no quarrel with the Amish for doing things the old-fashioned way. Their conscientious objection was tolerated in wartime, for after all, they are good farmers who 35 the virtues of work and thrift.

A) accessing	B) conveniences	C) destined	D) expanding
E) industrialized	F) perceived	G) practice	H) process
I) progress	J) respective	K) survived	L) terminals
M) undergone	N) universal	O) vanished	



手机扫码观看/分享

It is important that scientists be seen as normal people asking and answering important questions. Good, sound science depends on 26, experiments and reasoned methodologies. It requires a willingness to ask new questions and try new approaches. It requires one to take risks and experience failures. But good science also requires 27 understanding, clear explanation and concise presentation.

Our country needs more scientists who are willing to step out in the public 28 and offer their opinions on important matters. We need more scientists who can explain what they are doing in language that is 29 and understandable to the public. Those of us who are not scientists should also be prepared to support public engagement by scientists, and to 30 scientific knowledge into our public communications.

Too many people in this country, including some among our elected leadership, still do not understand how science works or why robust, long-range investments in research vitally matter. In the 1960s, the United States 31 nearly 17% of discretionary (可酌情支配的) spending to research and development, 32 decades of economic growth. By 2008, the figure had fallen into the single 33. This occurs at a time when other nations have made significant gains in their own research capabilities.

At the University of California (UC), we 34 ourselves not only on the quality of our research, but also on its contribution to improving our world. To 35 the development of science from the lab bench to the market place, UC is investing our own money in our own good ideas.

- A. Arena
- C. Convincing
- E. Digits
- G. Hypotheses
- I. Incorporate
- K. Indulge
- M. Pride
- O. Warrant

- B. contextual
- D. devoted
- F. hasten
- H. impairing
- J. indefinite
- L. inertia
- N. reaping



手机扫码观看/分享

Let's say you love roller-skating. Just the thought of 26 on your roller-skates brings a smile to your face. You also know that roller-skating is excellent exercise. You have a 27 attitude toward it.

This description of roller-skating 28 the three components of an attitude: affect, cognition, and behavior. You love the activity; it's great fun. These feelings 29 the affective or emotional component; they are an important ingredient in attitudes. The knowledge we have about the object constitutes the cognitive component of an attitude. You understand the health 30 that the activity can bring. Finally, attitudes have a behavioral component. Our attitudes 31 us to go outside to enjoy roller-skating.

Now, we don't want to leave you with the 32 that these three components always work together 33. They don't; sometimes they clash. For example, let's say you love pizza (affective component); however, you have high cholesterol and understand (knowledge component) that eating pizza may be bad for your health. Which behavior will your attitude result in, eating pizza or 34 it? The answer depends on which component happens to be stronger. If you are walking past a pizza restaurant at lunchtime, your emotions and feelings probably will be stronger than your knowledge that pizza may not be the best food for your health. In that instance, you have pizza for lunch. If you are at home trying to decide where to go for dinner, however, the knowledge component may 35, and you decide to go where you can eat a healthier meal.

A) avoiding B) benefits C) highlight D) illustrates E) impression

F) improves G) inquiring H) perfectly I) positive J) prevail

K) primarily L) prompt M) specifications N) strapping O) typical

Keys

第一篇

- 26. [O] vanished
- 27. [M] undergone
- 28. [D] expanding
- 29. [K] survived
- 30. [H] process
- 31. [L] terminals
- 32. [E] industrialized
- 33. [F] perceived
- 34. [B] conveniences
- 35. [G] practice

第二篇 26.G)hypotheses

- 27.B)contextual
- 28.A)arena
- 29.C)convincing
- 30.I)incorporate
- 31.D)devoted
- 32.N)reaping
- 33.E)digits
- 34.M)pride
- 35.F)hasten

第三篇

- 26. 【答案】 N
- 27. 【答案】 I
- 28. 【答案】 D
- 29. 【答案】 C
- 30. 【答案】 B
- 31. 【答案】 L
- 32. 【答案】 E
- 33. 【答案】 H
- 34. 【答案】 A
- 35. 【答案】 J